The Launch Pad

Volume 0 - The Story, the Floor, and the Door (all three years)

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The Launch Pad Story

A three-year studio for learners aged 16 to 18 Status: v0.1 working draft - locked structure, Season One built deep | **+ Ring-1 revisions (2026-08-28)** and **Ring-2 revisions (2026-08-31)** appended at the end (canonical cross-cutting doctrine: the closing practice, the layer rule, the through-line spine, binding fallow, decline-as-covenant, the graduated safety floor, guide-as-safety-member, the runway tiers; then the Ring-2 buildable subset - fixed closing prompts, Vineyard-in-Origin, season-scale re-crossing, the Curious No, the two-worlds hinge, the daily-ritual through-line, crew-not-watch, and the "deliberately NOT built" refusal architecture) and the Tue/Thu weekly-rhythm reconciliation applied inline **Date:** 2026-06-24 **Origin:** Evoke Passion fleet meeting (8 voices) facilitated for Europa, toward a presentation for Jenna

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The spine (the one-breath version)

Launch Pad is three expeditions. Every learner walks all three before they launch - in whatever order their cohort is on.

- **Origin** *(the set-up) - Who am I?* (Know your story.)
- **The Forge** *(the problem) - What is worth solving?* (Find your work.)
- **The Helm** *(the resolution) - What do I do when there is no easy answer?* (Make the hard call - and love the life around it.)

Each year is a complete hero's journey. Each carries one constant thread: a learner-owned **Captain's Log** that deepens every year. We are not running a high school. We are forming people who can think for themselves, make hard decisions, and love their lives.

> *"We are not training grim problem-solvers. We are forming captains who tend the vineyard, play the flute, love their crew - and can still make the hard call."*

How it works

The program is a cycle. The learner is a line.

The **cycle** turns Set-Up to Problem to Resolution forever, like seasons. The **learner** walks their own Captain's Log from the day they arrive to the day they launch - that is their three-act story, and it holds no matter which season they entered.

Names are by lens, never by number. There is no "Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3," because that would rank a learner who enters mid-cycle as "behind." A learner entering mid-cycle is **joining the story in progress**, never arriving late. You ride the cycle once fully around before you launch; you may join at any season.

The three seasons are named **Origin**, **The Forge**, and **The Helm** - an arc of agency (given, then forged, then at the helm). The story-beats (set-up, problem, resolution) are kept as a quiet descriptor so the structure stays legible to parents and learners.

The weekly rhythm (all three seasons)

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Project work	**Launch** (guide)	Project work	**Launch** (guide)	**Fallow / hearth day**

*(Ring-1 reconciliation, 2026-08-28: guide-led Launch days are **Tuesday & Thursday**, resolving a standing contradiction with the year plans - the operating reason is concrete: the guide is with Vibrant Life Tots on Mon/Wed, so guided studio runs Tue/Thu. Tue/Thu governs; this line supersedes the earlier Mon/Wed placement.)*

- **Two Launch days** with the Launch Pad Guide. The Guide is a **life-coach, not a teacher**: Socratic, holds questions rather than answers, has permission to say "I don't know - let's walk into it together."
- **Two project days** for self-directed work: core academics and high-school requirements, personal projects, and the season's writing.
- **A fallow / hearth day on a regular cadence.** Protected. Celebrated. Never earned, never filled. Rest, play, friendship, making-for-no-reason. This is practice, not reward.
- Every Launch day eases in with a self-directed project hour, then gathers for a body-first settle and a "how are you, really?" circle before the quest work, and closes with something glad - a laugh, a gratitude, a small good moment.

A day with the Guide, a day without the Guide

The learner's day runs 9:00 am to 1:30 pm.

A Launch day (with the Guide), 9:00 - 1:30:

Time	Block	What happens
9:00 - 10:00	Walk-in & Project Hour	Arrive at your own pace; self-directed work - reading, core academics, goal-setting. A soft, working start. The Guide is present and available, not directing.
10:00 - 10:25	Opening Circle	The settle (body-first) + "how are you, really?" The cohort gathers; presence before content.
10:25 - 10:40	The Quest Frame	The Guide opens the session's quest as a question, not a lecture.
10:40 - 11:45	The Work of the Day	The core activity - this is the slot that changes per session. Learner-led; the Guide holds questions, not answers.
11:45 - 12:15	The Table	A shared meal - the joy and belonging practice.
12:15 - 1:10	Apply & Collaborate	Carry the quest into hands-on and collaborative work; project application.
1:10 - 1:30	The Bridge + Glad Close	Name the next step to carry into project days (a self-chosen proximal goal); a light close.

Why open with a working hour: it gives latecomers grace, eases learners in through self-direction before a social circle (a gift for the anxious or introverted), and signals that even a guided day is the learner's own. The settle-and-circle still opens the *together* work; the glad close still bookends it.

A project day (without the Guide), same 9:00 - 1:30 window, self-directed:

Flow	What happens
Self-set intention	The learner names today's focus - the next step they chose at the Launch's Bridge.

Flow	What happens
Deep-work blocks	Reading, core academics / HS requirements, the personal project, and the season's writing. 90-minute cycles.
Peer collaboration	Optional - problems and projects are often built with others.
The Log	Capture the day in the Captain's Log (theirs alone).

The Guide is off the floor on these days - available if asked, never directing. That absence is the lesson: a young person learns they can hold their own hours. On cadence, a project day *is* the fallow / hearth day - rest, play, friendship - protected and never converted back into work.

The Captain's Log (the constant thread)

One learner-owned artifact, carried and deepened across all three seasons. The learner names it themselves. It survives rotation: the order of seasons changes what they write *about*; it never changes that they are writing. **It belongs to the learner. A guide never reads it for assessment** - the moment it becomes surveillance, the trust architecture collapses.

The Next Great Adventure (the graduation rite, off the cycle)

The send-off is not tied to a season. It is the learner's **personal graduation rite**, overlaid on whatever season they leave from. Every graduating captain gets their launch - one Next Great Adventure, at the true end of *their* line. (A learner who meets the Resolution season early rehearses the "what's next" question years before they answer it for real. That is practice, not redundancy.)

Each season keeps its own lens-true harvest (Session 7)

Season	Session 7 harvest
The Set-Up	**The Unveiling** - self-portrait / "This Is Me" exhibition
The Problem	**The Call to Action** - public advocacy talk: a problem worth solving + their service response
The Resolution	**The Council** - public deliberation of a real moral dilemma / leadership demonstration
Any season, a learner's final year	**Your Next Great Adventure** - personal graduation launch

The “Live & Love Life” thread (joy woven in, not bolted on)

Joy is part of the formation, not the reward for it. It runs as the **register** of the work, plus **protected unstructured space**, and the Guide **models** a life worth loving. It is invitational and unmeasured: joy assigned is joy destroyed.

Each season has its own flavor of joy, tied to its lens:

Season	Its joy
The Set-Up	**Roots & belonging** - the foods, music, and stories of your lineage; wonder at your own story; play with who you are
The Problem	**Curiosity & company** - the delight of the “aha”; solving *with* friends; expeditions out into the world; the warmth of service done together
The Resolution	**Expression & camaraderie** - theatre and the stage as play; the fellowship of leading together; awe at big questions; the adult joy of choosing life *because* you have looked at hard things

Recurring practices (the register, present in every season):

- **Expeditions** - regular real-world and outdoor adventures. These are teenagers; get them moving, in nature, in the world. Adventure for its own sake, not only to study something.
- **The Table** - shared meals as ritual. A regular communal meal, and a feast at every harvest.
- **The Arts** - music, movement, making, theatre present throughout, not quarantined in one season.
- **Belonging** - cohort friendship rituals; celebrating each other, not only individual work.
- **The Fallow Day** - protected, celebrated, never filled.
- **The Glad Close** - Launches can end with something light.

Guard rails: invited, never assigned; unmeasured, never graded; the fallow stays fallow; the Guide lives it rather than instructs it. The Guide’s own joy is part of the curriculum, which is why Guide sustainability is in the plan.

The six refusals (the floor under everything)

From the 2026-06-14 quest-cycle research brief. All of Launch Pad sits inside these:

1. No grades or quantified completion rates visible to anyone but the learner
2. No ranking, leaderboards, or peer-visible progress
3. No banking-model knowledge deposit - the learner co-creates meaning; the Guide does not author it for them
4. No external deadline imposition - the learner sets pace; "I didn't get to it" is honored
5. No productivity-as-worth framing - mastery language; an abandoned-with-learning quest is honored equally with a completed one
6. No audit-culture surveillance - the data belongs to the learner, not the school

Plus the **right to refuse the structure itself**: a learner who declines a quest is fully honored, not coded as opt-out failure.

Locked decisions

1. **Three lenses, not three grades.** Each season is a complete hero's journey containing identity + problem + resolution at its own altitude; rotation works because the seasons rotate around a *portable* foundation, not because they are order-independent. *(Refined 2026-08-31, MAC/Kirk - see Ring-2 revision #6: the honest claim is foundation-dependence-with-a-portable-foundation, not season-independence. Origin's three functions - a self named, agency claimed, a routine that holds - are the keel every other season sails on; the Fast-Origin seed for mid-cycle joiners exists precisely because that keel is a prerequisite. A learner can enter at any season, but not without carrying a compressed Origin as ballast.)*
2. **One constant thread.** The learner-owned Captain's Log, deepened across all three seasons, surviving rotation. Doubles as Jenna's one tangible object.
3. **Joy & rest are structural.** Regular fallow/hearth day; body-first settle + "how are you, really?" to open; harvests are real celebrations.
4. **Resume reframed.** The Set-Up produces a "story-of-self portfolio"; the resume is one true page inside it, framed as a sovereignty tool, not the season's reduction.
5. **Year-3 safety architecture is binding.** Allegory-first; opt-out without explanation; no required self-disclosure; dilemmas resolve into *reasoning*, never "the right answer"; Guide trained to pivot.
6. **Guide sustainability in the plan.** Supervision, peer support, and rest for the Guide written into what Jenna sees. Guide = life-coach with permission to not-know.

7. **The six refusals + right-to-refuse-structure govern all of it.**
8. **One Next Great Adventure, and it is a graduation rite** - lifted off the cycle, overlaid on each learner's final year.
9. **Each season keeps a lens-true harvest** - Unveiling / Call to Action / Council. No season borrows another's ending.
10. **"Live & Love Life" is a woven thread, not a wrapper** - per-season joy-flavor + recurring practices + Guide models it, all invitational and unmeasured.
11. **Set-Up Sessions 5 & 6 split as expansion to distillation** - S5 "The Full Draft" (claim the whole life, no shaping); S6 "Chapter One" (author's craft; keep the load-bearing, cut-to-focus-not-to-hide, the rest kept in the Captain's Log, second distillation into the story-of-self / resume page). "Chapter one" framed as *hope* - proof the book is not finished.
12. **Family-story safety net (binding for Set-Up S2 & S5)** - family = who made you (chosen/found included); opt-out without explanation; heavy material previewed with a real exit; potluck is belonging not performance.
13. **The Next Great Adventure - separate the rite from the question.** The *rite* (graduation send-off) stays bound to each learner's final year, whatever season that is - one send-off at the true end of their line. The *question* ("what is your next great adventure?") opens as a standing invitation from any season, any time, especially for graduating learners. Season Three rehearses the question for everyone without it being anyone's premature send-off.

SEASON ONE: ORIGIN (the set-up) - deep build

Lens: Who am I? Joy-flavor: roots & belonging. "The soul never thinks without a mental image." - Aristotle

What your learner walks away with *(share with parents at the start of the year):* - A **story-of-self portfolio**, with a one-page resume inside it - Real **confidence in where they came from and who they are now - 100 dreams named** - and the courage to dream bigger - Practical footing: **time management, communication, routine**, and progress on HS requirements - The first chapters of their **Captain's Log**, carried through all three years

The season's secret engine (tell Jenna this): Covey - *"All things are created twice; first mentally, then physically. The key to creativity is to begin with the end in mind."* The Set-Up is the **first creation** - dreaming it. The Problem and Resolution seasons are the **second** - building it.

The 7 sessions (4 short at 3-4 weeks, 3 long at about 6 weeks; Session 7 is the harvest):

Session 1 - "The Map of Me" *(short)*

- **Focus:** The 100 Dreams meeting - from Matthew Kelly's *The Dream Manager* (2007). Dream 100 personal dreams with courage; sort them by time horizon - more than 5 years out, within 5 years, and within 1 year (Kelly's three categories); and map them across the **five Compass regions** the learner already navigates - Self, Others, Making, World, Voice - with warm dream-prompts nested inside each (Kelly's evocative words, teen-relabeled). *(Fleet decision 2026-08-21: the five-region spine keeps one coherent map and honors the 2026-07-21 retirement of the per-studio multi-area wheel; Kelly's warm words fill the prompt layer. See decision log.)* Then the **dream session** (Kelly's practice): share dreams aloud in a circle, where dreams prove contagious - hearing another's dream makes you reach for your pen and add it to your own.
- **Anchor:** Covey - created twice, begin with the end in mind. This dream-set is the mental creation the whole cycle will physically build toward. The far-horizon dreams are the "end" to begin with; the within-1-year dreams become the season's first proximal goals.
- **Launches:** the 100 Dreams practice (write 100, no filtering - assigned ahead so the session opens with material to discuss); the **dream session** (share aloud; dreams are contagious); sort by horizon (more than 5 years / within 5 years / within 1 year); map across the five Compass regions (Self/Others/Making/World/Voice, with nested dream-prompts); a Socratic courage pass - "which of these scares you a little? Courage points there."
- **Project days:** begin the Captain's Log; start core academics / HS requirements rhythm.
- **Joy:** the thrill of permission to dream without a ceiling; wonder at possibility.

Session 2 - "The Lineage" *(short)*

- **Focus:** The family tree as **mythos** - the stories of your lineage gathered the way deep culture is gathered. Family interviews. The recipes and foods of where you come from.
- **Listening model:** the *Midnight Gospel* "Mortality and the Mind" episode (Duncan Trussell interviewing his mother weeks before her death) - a masterclass in an ordinary life carrying enormous meaning. Preview it; watch the room.
- **Harvest-within:** a **family-story potluck** - everyone brings a dish and a story.
- **Launches:** how to gather a story; how to interview someone you love; how to listen for the story under the facts.
- **Project days:** conduct interviews; gather recipes; write up family stories into the Log.
- **Joy:** the potluck feast; the foods and music of lineage; belonging.
- **Safety (binding):** family = who made you (biological, chosen, found - mentors, grandparents, a coach, a sibling all count). Opt-out on any interview with no explanation owed. The mortality episode previewed, with somewhere to step out *to*. The potluck is belonging, not performance - a store-bought dish is fully welcome.

Session 3 - "The Power of Choice" *(short)*

- **Focus:** Choice as the engine of a life. The relationship between responsibility, freedom, and choice as one knot, not three topics.
- **Practice:** start each day with **choice games** - small, playful, real decisions and their consequences, so choosing becomes muscle.
- **Launches:** the choice games; Socratic work on "where did a choice change everything?"
- **Project days:** personal projects; HS requirements; Log entries on choices made.
- **Joy:** play - the games are genuinely fun; agency feels good in the body.
- **Sets up:** Sessions 5-6, where shaping your own story *is* the power of choice applied to narrative.

Session 4 - "Running My Own Ship" *(short)*

- **Focus:** Time management; communication; finishing HS requirements. A **midpoint reflection** on Sessions 1-3 and how the learner is evolving. Routine.
- **The frame to teach:** routine is not the opposite of freedom - it is what makes freedom possible. Responsibility, freedom, and choice, lived as a rhythm that fits *you*.
- **Launches:** building a routine that holds; communication practice; the look-back ("what have these first weeks shown you about yourself?").
- **Project days:** catch up / get ahead on HS requirements; refine the personal-project plan.
- **Joy:** the quiet satisfaction of a rhythm that fits; a clear desk; momentum.

Session 5 - "The Full Draft" *(long) - EXPANSION*

- **Focus:** Claim your whole life. Write all of it - messy, complete, unedited. No shaping yet. Nothing is too small. This is the autobiography in full.
- **Why first:** they need the relief of getting it all down before they can bear to start choosing what to keep.
- **Scaffolding prompts (the Guide opens the draft with these):**
    - *Turning points:* "Name a moment after which you were not the same. What changed?"
    - *Sensory doorways:* a place, a smell, a song, a meal, a room - memory lives in the body before it lives in words.
    - *The people:* "Who made you? Not just family - anyone who left a mark."
    - *The hard and the best:* the worst day, the best day, and what each taught.
    - *A slice of life:* "Write one ordinary day at age ____, start to finish." (This is the "slices of life.")

- **Listening models (how an ordinary life becomes a story):** StoryCorps (recorded real lives - a full interview runs ~40 min; their animated shorts distill them to a few minutes), memoir excerpts, the *Midnight Gospel* episode. Coming-of-age songs as **mirrors, not molds** - "which line is about you?" then back to their own words.
- **Joy:** the relief and catharsis of claiming a whole life; being witnessed.
- **Safety:** the same family-story net applies - some lives carry loss; opt-out on any memory.

Session 6 - "Chapter One" *(long) - DISTILLATION*

- **Focus:** Become the author. A chapter is not a smaller version of your life - it is a shaped thing with a throughline. Learn to find it.
- **The reframe that makes it land for a teenager:** to a 16-year-old, this *is* their whole life - so do not argue with that, flip it. **Shrinking it to "chapter one" is an act of hope: it declares there are chapters coming.** It does not make their life small; it makes their future big.
- **The truth-discipline (teach explicitly):** we never cut to hide, we cut to **focus**. What you leave out of chapter one is not denied or erased - it is *kept*, in the full draft, in the Captain's Log. It is still true. It just is not load-bearing for *this* chapter's shape. Cutting is choosing what matters most right now - the power of choice from Session 3, turned into craft.
- **The shrink mechanic (the Guide holds this):**
    1. From the full draft, find the **throughline** - "what is this chapter *about*?" (One sentence.)
    2. Choose the **3-5 load-bearing moments** that set up who you are becoming. *Keep, because* - not *cut, because*.
    3. Write **Chapter One** - tight, shaped, true.
    4. Everything cut goes into the **Captain's Log** as the full draft - kept, honored, not lost.
    5. Distill the *same life* into a **second shape: the one-page story-of-self / resume.** Same material, two forms - a *story* (meaning) and a *page* (practical). Two answers to "who are you," for two different rooms. This is also what makes the resume different from the autobiography: not a smaller story, a different *kind* of distillation.
- **Joy:** the craft delight of shaping; the hope of "chapters to come."

Session 7 - "This Is Me" / The Unveiling *(long) - HARVEST*

- **Focus:** A self-portrait / art piece. A "This Is Me" piece. Present who-you-are, the story-of-self portfolio, the resume page, Chapter One.
- **The bookend:** dreamed in S1, drafted in S5, shaped in S6, *declared* in S7. If the closing anthem is "This Is Me," the year rhymes from end to end.
- **Form:** a real celebration with a real audience - a feast, not a presentation.

- **Joy:** being seen by your people; the unveiling feast.

Origin at the day level

Every session runs the same two-day skeleton - a Launch day (9:00 to 1:30, with the Guide) and self-directed project days. Only the Launch's *Work of the Day* and the project focus change. Here is that change across Origin's seven sessions:

Session	Launch "Work of the Day" (across the session's weeks)	Project-day focus
S1 The Map of Me	100 Dreams (Matthew Kelly, *The Dream Manager*) assigned Day 1; the **dream session** (share aloud - dreams are contagious); sort by horizon (5+ / within 5 / within 1 yr); map across the five Compass regions (nested dream-prompts); "which dreams scare you?" courage pass; Covey's created-twice frame	Write the 100 dreams (homework from Day 1); open the Captain's Log; pick 3 within-1-year dreams to orient the season; reading, core / HS
S2 The Lineage	How to gather a story and interview someone you love; the Midnight Gospel listen (previewed, exit open); map the family mythos; the family-story potluck	Conduct family interviews; gather recipes; write family stories into the Log; reading, core / HS
S3 The Power of Choice	Daily choice games; the responsibility-freedom-choice knot; "where did a choice change everything?"	Choice journaling in the Log; personal project; goal-setting practice; core / HS
S4 Running My Own Ship	Build a routine that fits you (routine = freedom); communication practice; midpoint reflection on S1-3	Catch up or get ahead on HS requirements; design your own routine; refine the personal-project plan
S5 The Full Draft	The scaffolding prompts (turning points, sensory doorways, the people, hard and best, a slice of life); listening models (StoryCorps, memoir, coming-of-age songs as mirrors); write-it-all	Write the full autobiography draft (lots of writing time); read the models; reading, core / HS
S6 Chapter One	What a chapter is (throughline); the "chapter one = hope" reframe; the cut-to-focus truth-discipline; the shrink mechanic	Do the shrink; write Chapter One; build the story-of-self portfolio and the one-page resume

Session	Launch "Work of the Day" (across the session's weeks)	Project-day focus
S7 This Is Me / The Unveiling	Make the self-portrait / "This Is Me" art piece; prepare the exhibition; the bookend anthem; the Unveiling feast	Build the art piece; finalize the portfolio; rehearse the unveiling

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SEASON TWO: THE FORGE (the problem) - deep build

Lens: what is worth solving? Joy-flavor: curiosity & company. "Things are only impossible until they're not." - Jean-Luc Picard

What your learner walks away with *(share with parents at the start of the year):* - A **real problem they chose** because it matters to them - The skill to **name a problem precisely and trace it to its root** - A **service or philanthropy project** they acted on, with real people - Experience **collaborating and failing forward** - A public **Call to Action talk** that can move a room

This is where Origin's dreaming becomes building - the **second creation** Covey named.

The season's signature daily ritual: the **Impossible Question.** Year One opened each morning with choice games; Year Two opens with a question that has no clean answer, debated playfully ("Could we end loneliness?" "Can one person change a system?"). The point is never to answer it - it is to grow comfortable standing inside something too big to close. Run it all season; intensify it in Session 5.

The 7 sessions (4 short, 3 long; Session 7 is the harvest):

Session 1 - "Naming the Dragon" *(short)*

- **Focus:** the distinction nobody hands teenagers - a **problem** (you can act on it), a **fact of life** (accept it), a **preference** (you just want it), a **mystery** (sit with it). You fight a dragon differently depending which it is.
- **Games / teaching:**
  - *"Problem or Not?"* - a sorting game. Cards with real situations sorted into the four buckets. The arguments over the gray cards are the lesson.
  - *"Reframe It" to "How Might We"* - crank a complaint ("history is pointless") into a design-thinking question ("how might we make this matter?"). A complaint is a closed door; a How-Might-We is an open one.

    - *The Iceberg* - surface problem vs. the thing underneath (sets up the Detective).
- **Teaching image:** a vague dragon ("everything sucks") cannot be fought; a named one can. Naming precisely is half the victory.
- **Joy:** the relief of turning a fog of dread into a thing with a name.

Session 2 - "The Detective" *(short)*

- **Focus:** investigation as root-cause analysis - observe, gather evidence, separate symptom from cause, keep asking *why* (the 5 Whys) until you hit bedrock. The obvious culprit is almost never the root cause.
- **The session is itself an act of choice - the cohort picks one of three formats:**

Option	What they do	What it teaches best
(a) The Ready Mystery	Guide brings a finished whodunit; learners are detectives	The investigation skill, fast - pure root-cause practice
(b) Build-Your-Own	Learners design a mystery for another group to solve	The deepest - to write a mystery you must think like the system that made it
(c) The Speakeasy	An immersive, roam-the-room whodunit; clues hidden in the space	Experiential and kinesthetic; a first taste of theatre (foreshadows Year 3)

- **A ready mystery for Option A - "A Death at Greywater Manor":**
    - *Setup:* Eleanor Vance, celebrated food entrepreneur and town philanthropist, found dead after a dinner party mid-storm, manor cut off. Six guests, each a motive and a secret.
    - *Suspects:* the Business Partner (about to be bought out), the Estranged Daughter (cut from the will), the Head Chef (publicly humiliated that night), the Town Councillor (about to be exposed), the Old Friend (secretly bankrupt, owed money), the Journalist (here to break a story about Eleanor's company).
    - *The play:* detectives interview suspects (peers or Guide), examine clues, build theories. Every suspect looks guilty in turn - that is the trap.
    - *The twist (the teaching):* run the 5 Whys. Why did she die? A reaction to her food. Why? The kitchen's allergen labeling failed. Why? Staff overworked and undertrained. Why? Eleanor had gutted the kitchen budget to fund the buyout. Why? Her company was bleeding money after being cited for contaminating the town's water. **No one murdered Eleanor. A system did.** The obvious villain is a symptom; the root cause is the rot underneath.
    - *The transfer:* the Guide then asks each learner to name a real problem and run the same 5 Whys - who is the obvious suspect, what is the system underneath?

- **Safety:** keep it Clue-style, cartoonish, bloodless - no graphic violence. Offer a lighter swap ("who sabotaged the harvest festival," "who killed the river") for any learner for whom a murder lands wrong. Same mechanics, same systemic twist.
- **Joy:** company and play; teens love this.

Session 3 - "My Arena" *(short)*

- **Focus:** right-sizing. Covey's **Circle of Concern / Influence** (his original two-circle model; **Circle of Control** is a common later third-ring extension, not Covey's own). Energy spent only in the Concern ring burns out into cynicism; the shift is to find the arena where action actually moves something.
- **What it looks like:**
  - *The Three Circles map* - list everything you worry about; sort into Control / Influence / Concern-only; watch where the energy can actually act.
  - *Agency inventory* - what you concretely have right now: skills, time, relationships, resources.
  - *The starter quest* - each learner picks one small real problem inside their arena and acts on it during project days. A win they can feel (proximal goal, self-efficacy spiral).
- **Ties to Year One's Power of Choice:** the move from "problems happen to me" to "I can act on this slice."
- **Joy:** the quiet power of "this one is mine, and I can move it."

Session 4 - "The Wider Field" *(short)*

- **Focus:** lift their eyes from their own arena to the world's. They **choose the problem that matters to them** - never assigned. The finding question is not "what is important?" but *"what breaks your heart?"* (Buechner: where your deep gladness meets the world's deep hunger.)
- **What it looks like:**
  - *An expedition* - go out to where a real problem lives (a shelter, a riverbank, a food bank, a council meeting). See it firsthand. The season's joy-flavor made real.
  - *The Problem Gallery* - a walk past real-world problems (the UN goals, local issues, environmental, social). Which one will not let them go?
  - *Stakeholder intro* - who actually has this problem? (Sets up Session 6's empathy work.)
  - Choose the problem they carry through Sessions 5-7.
- **Safety:** world problems can drown a teenager in despair (eco-anxiety, doom). Always pair the wider field with agency - you do not have to solve all of it; you pick your slice. Hope, not helplessness. The expedition should leave them lit up, not crushed.

Session 5 - "The Long Game" *(long)*

- **Focus:** can big problems be solved? Picard's line is the title-card. Big problems are **systems, not single acts** - no hero solves them alone. You break the impossible into the next doable step (proximal goals), find the leverage point, and collaborate.
- **The Impossible Question intensifies here** - this is the season ritual at full strength.
- **Three doors into the impossible (modalities - the Guide chooses how far to open each):**
  - *Clowning / play* - the clown faces what is too big by making it approachable, and fails constantly while turning failure into delight. This is **failing-forward** embodied: improv, "yes-and," permission to be gloriously wrong. The safest of the three and the best regulator - lead with it.
  - *The inner child* - children ask "why not?" before anyone teaches them a thing is impossible. Reconnects them to fearless curiosity.
  - *The shadow* - the uncomfortable truth inside a problem that nobody wants to name. Most big problems stay unsolved because of what everyone is avoiding.
- **Safety (binding):** aim shadow and inner-child work at **the shadow of the problem, not forced excavation of the self.** Ask "what is the uncomfortable truth inside this issue?" - never "what is your childhood wound?" Opt-out always available. Shadow comes last, lightest touch, fully invitational.
- **Content under the play:** systems thinking, leverage points, collaboration, iteration, failing forward.
- **Joy:** clowning; the company of collaborators; the awe of big questions.

Session 6 - "Hands to Work" *(long) - finish line*

- **Focus:** real action on the chosen problem. **Present the choice** - do not assign service; offer a menu and let the learner choose how they serve. Assigned service teaches compliance; chosen service teaches contribution.

Mode	What it is
Direct service	Hands-on, face-to-face with people affected
Advocacy	Raising the alarm, changing minds
Philanthropy	Giving - time and skill, not only money
Building	Making a thing that helps
Teaching	Passing on what you know to others facing the problem

- **Core skill:** empathy - design *with* the people who have the problem, never *for* them. Talk to real, affected humans.

- **Safety:** do not place teenagers in emotionally over-their-head situations with vulnerable populations without support. Service should stretch, not wound.
- **Joy:** the warmth of service done together.

Session 7 - "The Call to Action" *(long) - harvest*

- **Focus:** the public advocacy talk. Each learner makes the case: here is a problem worth solving, here is why it broke my heart, here is what I did and learned, here is what I am asking of you. This is **advocacy, not a sales pitch** (distinct from Year Three's venture pitch) - the art is making a room care.
- **Structure to teach (simply):** Problem to Stakes to Story to The Ask. Vulnerability is the persuasive force, not polish.
- **Form:** a feast, not a presentation. Real audience; the cohort cheers each other.
- **Joy:** being heard; the company of a cohort that has your back.

The Forge at the day level

Same two-day skeleton; only the Work of the Day and project focus change:

Session	Launch "Work of the Day" (across the session's weeks)	Project-day focus
S1 Naming the Dragon	"Problem or Not?" sorting game; Reframe-It to How-Might-We; the Iceberg	Reframe their own complaints into How-Might-We statements; Log; reading, core / HS
S2 The Detective	Cohort picks the format (ready mystery / build-your-own / speakeasy); run "A Death at Greywater Manor"; the 5 Whys; transfer to a real problem	Run the 5 Whys on a real problem of their own; investigate; Log; core / HS
S3 My Arena	The Three Circles map (Concern / Influence / Control); agency inventory; choose a starter quest	Act on a small real problem in their arena; Log; core / HS
S4 The Wider Field	The expedition (go see a problem firsthand); the Problem Gallery; "what breaks your heart?"; stakeholder intro	Research their chosen world problem; map stakeholders; commit to the problem they carry; core / HS
S5 The Long Game	The Impossible Question at full strength; the clowning / inner-child / shadow doors; systems thinking, leverage, collaboration, failing forward	Break the big problem into proximal steps; prototype; collaborate; Log; core / HS

Session	Launch "Work of the Day" (across the session's weeks)	Project-day focus
S6 Hands to Work	Present the service-choice menu; empathy and design-with; plan and begin real action	Carry out the service / philanthropy project, with real people; Log; core / HS
S7 The Call to Action	Talk structure (Problem, Stakes, Story, Ask); rehearse; the public talk and feast	Build and rehearse the talk; finalize the project; reading, core / HS

SEASON THREE: THE HELM (the resolution) - deep build

Lens: what do I do when there is no easy answer? Joy-flavor: expression & camaraderie. "The first duty of every Starfleet officer is to the truth." / The Kobayashi Maru: the test was never how to win - it was how to face a no-win scenario without losing yourself.

What your learner walks away with *(share with parents at the start of the year):* - The capacity to **make a hard call from principle** - and live with it - Practice **reasoning through real moral dilemmas** (not memorizing answers) - A **professional mentor** in their field of interest - **Leadership experience** - leading peers, and being led well - A public **Council**: deliberating a real dilemma in front of an audience

Binding safety floor (applies to the whole season): everything runs through **allegory**; opt-out on anything with no explanation owed; no learner is ever required to disclose their own experience to participate; dilemmas resolve into **reasoning, never "the right answer"**; the Guide is trained to watch the room and pivot. Held, this season transforms; unheld, it wounds. Specific danger points are flagged per session.

The 7 sessions (4 short, 3 long; Session 7 is the harvest):

Session 1 - "The Mantle" *(short) - imposter games*

- **Focus:** Who are you to solve problems? Why you? Imposter feelings spike in adolescence *for a reason* - they arrive when identity forms and stakes rise. Not a flaw; the feeling of reaching past your current self. Name that first.
- **The imposter games:**
  - *The Fraud Confession* - everyone shares a time they felt like a fraud; Guide goes first; invite a mentor. Seeing accomplished adults feel it dissolves its power. (Opt-out - shame lives close for some.)
  - *"Why not you?"* - flip every "who am I to do this" into "who else, if not you?"

    - *The Evidence File* - counter the imposter's lie with real evidence of competence (pulls from the Year-One portfolio).
    - *The Mantle ceremony* - put on a cloak/role and act with authority you do not yet feel. The lesson lands in the body: act before you feel ready, and worthiness follows.
- **The teaching:** worthiness is chosen, not earned. Leadership never required certainty; it required acting rightly inside uncertainty.
- **Joy:** the play of stepping into a role bigger than you feel.

Session 2 - "No Easy Answers" *(short) - TNG + the great cases of history*

- **Focus:** moral dilemmas through TNG allegory, each tied to a real human case. The allegory is the safety feature - a room can debate personhood through Data's trial without anyone confessing a thing.

TNG episode	The dilemma	Real case to tie it to
The Measure of a Man	Is Data property or a person?	Dred Scott; abolition; modern AI/ personhood
The Drumhead	Security vs. liberty; the witch-hunt	McCarthyism; Salem; post-9/11 surveillance
I, Borg	Do you use an enemy as a weapon?	The atomic bomb decision; total war
Symbiosis	Aid vs. non-interference; dependency	Colonialism; humanitarian intervention
Justice	One punishment for any crime; mercy vs. law	Mandatory minimums; proportionality
The First Duty	Truth vs. loyalty; the cover-up	Whistleblowing; institutional loyalty

- **The win is reasoning, not the answer.** Introduce frameworks lightly - consequences, duties, character, care - and Kohlberg's stages. Holding the tension and reasoning from principle is arrival; a tidy verdict usually skipped the lesson.
- **Safety (flag):** preview-and-alternate the heaviest - *Ethics* (assisted death), *The Outcast* (identity/conformity), *Chain of Command* (coercion). Keep alternates ready; opt-out stands.
- **Joy:** the thrill of a real argument among friends who stay friends.

Session 3 - "The Ripple" *(short) - what-if games*

- **Focus:** consequence-thinking; thinking several moves ahead; second- and third-order effects. Good captains think in ripples, not points.
- **The what-if games:**
  - *The Ripple Board* - pose a "what if" and map outcomes in waves: 1st-order (immediate), 2nd-order (then what?), 3rd-order (then what?). Chasing the cascade is the game.
  - *The Monkey's Paw* - every wish granted with an unforeseen cost; the shadow side of "solutions."
  - *Counterfactual history* - "what if X never happened?" Watch systems ripple.
  - *The Pre-Mortem (ties Year 2 to Year 3)* - imagine last season's solution succeeded wildly and then caused a new problem. What is the shadow of your fix?
- **Joy:** the delight of chasing a cascade to absurd and revealing places.

Session 4 - "The Stage" *(short) - theatre*

- **Focus:** theatre as embodiment and perspective-taking - stepping into another life, especially a hard one. The stage's distance is a safety feature, like allegory: you can *be* the person who makes the other choice.
- **The keystone text - "Our Town" (Wilder):** its question - *"Do any human beings ever realize life while they live it?"* - is the "live and love life" thread spoken from the stage. Emily returns from death to relive one ordinary day. It rhymes with the Year-One mortality work.
- **Also:**
  - *Monologue work* - each learner finds or writes a monologue from someone facing a hard call (TNG, history, literature). Speaking another's truth from the inside.
  - *Archetypes* - Hero, Mentor, Shadow, Trickster, Ruler, Caregiver as roles to step into, not become. "I encountered the Hero," never "I am the Hero." A doorway, not an identity.
  - *Forum Theatre (Boal)* - act out a dilemma, then let the audience stop the scene and try a different choice. Deliberation made physical; feeds Session 7's Council.
- **Safety (flag):** learners choose their roles and can opt out of any; close with a **de-roling ritual** (stepping cleanly out of a heavy character). *Our Town*'s death scene can land on real grief; hold it.
- **Joy:** expression; the play of becoming someone else for an hour.

Session 5 - "The Arena of Voices" *(long) - professional mentors*

- **Focus:** finding and working with real professional mentors in the field the learner has circled all cycle. Being mentored is a threshold - being seen by someone you admire.
- **What it looks like:**
  - *Mentor matching* - connect each learner with a working professional in their area of interest.
  - *The art of being mentored (a real, teachable skill)* - how to reach out, ask a question worth a busy person's time, follow up. (The "read their published work before first contact" discipline belongs here.)
  - *The informational interview* - and note: interviewing is now a through-skill across all three years (family, stakeholders, mentors).
  - *The pitch* - present their thinking to real professionals; receive real feedback. A mentor is a different kind of guide: not the life-coach, but someone living the life the learner is curious about.
- **Joy:** the company of someone further down a road you want to walk.

Session 6 - "The Bridge" *(long) - group leadership - finish line*

- **Focus:** leading peers; the captain's chair. Leadership is stewardship, not command - the measure of a leader is what continues when they step back. Lead toward your own unnecessity.
- **What it looks like:**
  - *Rotating command* - everyone leads a real group task; everyone follows. Learn to lead by leading and by being led well.
  - *Find your style* - Picard, Kirk, Janeway, Sisko: four captains, four styles, all real. Which captain do you lead like?
  - *The hard parts* - feedback, the unpopular call, holding a group through conflict, delegating, good follower-ship.
  - *Expedition leadership* - a real group challenge outdoors where the chair rotates (joy: camaraderie + the outdoors).
- **Honor the quiet leaders:** leading softly from the back is a different leadership, not a weaker one. Do not let "leadership" collapse into "loudest."
- **Joy:** camaraderie; the fellowship of leading together.

Session 7 - "The Council" *(long) - the hard call - harvest*

- **Focus:** a council is not a debate (a debate has a winner); it has discernment. Learners gather around a real dilemma and reason out loud, in front of their people - not performing certainty, but holding tension without collapsing it.

- **What it looks like:**
  - A real dilemma is put to the learners - a community question, a historical case, or a live ethical one. They deliberate publicly: reason from principle, name the cost, honor the dissent; a leader (mentored leadership demonstration) holds the room.
  - Feed in the Forum Theatre from Session 4 - act the dilemma, then council it.
  - The exhibition *is* the thinking, not a verdict. Witnesses see reasoning, not answers.
  - Leave the door open for the Kobayashi Maru move - the learner who refuses the binary and finds the third option. The captain's art, and the right note to end a formation on.
- **Safety:** the dilemma is allegorical/external, not personal; opt-out; no forced disclosure; a held container.
- **Form:** a feast, a real audience, the cohort holding each other.
- **Joy:** camaraderie; being witnessed reasoning honestly about something that matters.

The Helm at the day level

Same two-day skeleton; only the Work of the Day and project focus change:

Session	Launch "Work of the Day" (across the session's weeks)	Project-day focus
S1 The Mantle	The Fraud Confession; "Why not you?"; the Evidence File; the Mantle ceremony	Build the Evidence File from their portfolio; Log; reading, core / HS
S2 No Easy Answers	A TNG episode + its paired historical case; ethical frameworks and Kohlberg; reason-not-answer discussion (heaviest previewed, opt-out)	Research a paired real case; write their reasoning in the Log; core / HS
S3 The Ripple	The Ripple Board; the Monkey's Paw; counterfactual history; the Pre-Mortem on their Forge solution	Ripple-map or pre-mortem their own project; Log; core / HS
S4 The Stage	Our Town; monologue work; archetypes as doorways; Forum Theatre; the de-roling ritual	Find or write a monologue; rehearse; reading, core / HS
S5 The Arena of Voices	Mentor matching; the art of being mentored (outreach, the good question, follow-up); informational interviews; the pitch	Reach out to a mentor; conduct informational interviews; prepare the pitch; core / HS

Session	Launch “Work of the Day” (across the session’s weeks)	Project-day focus
S6 The Bridge	Rotating command; find-your-style (which captain do you lead like?); the hard parts of leading; expedition leadership	Lead a real group task; reflect on leading and following; Log; core / HS
S7 The Council	Deliberate a real dilemma in public; Forum-Theatre feed-in; mentored leadership demonstration; the feast	Prepare the council case; rehearse leadership; finalize; reading, core / HS

Open questions to confirm

1. **“NGA talk”** - read here as *Next Great Adventure* (now the graduation rite). If NGA is an established Vibrant Life talk format, name it and it will be reseated.
2. **Rotation mechanics** - do all learners rotate as one group year-to-year, or do the three seasons run simultaneously with mixed-age cohorts? (Changes the Captain’s Log handoff and the “join in progress” welcome.)
3. **The fifth weekday** - a 4-day instructional week, or does the fallow/hearth day land on a real fifth day?
4. **The 15-vs-18 span in one room** - how a Guide runs the same Launch at three developmental stages at once. (A “dive deeper” item.)

The room (8 voices)

Jean-Luc Picard, Kathryn Janeway, Jake Sisko, Guinan (USS Enterprise); Fabula, Comes, Salus, Accord (USS Evoke). Facilitated by Claude.

Ring-1 revisions (2026-08-28) - the canonical doctrine

After the full three-year design was built out (Origin/Forge/Helm + the Life Admin strand), Ring 1 (PDC + SSC + COC, 26 agents) reviewed the whole body, and leadership (Picard, Cura, Impetus, Sisko) ratified a set of cross-cutting fixes. These govern all three seasons; the year plans inherit them.

1. The one addition - the learner-held closing practice. The single most-converged finding across all three circles: *the design opens the interior faster than it closes it*. World-class opening practices (100 dreams, lineage, the worst-day, imposter work, mortality, the hard call); only local closing (de-roling closes a session, not the arc). The fix, and the *only* thing added: a small, **learner-held closing / integration practice - the emotional twin of the Reasoning Standard** - three prompts, shaped as a re-crossing: *what did I meet? what do I carry back? what's different in me now - even a little?* (three fixed spoken lines, no artifact ever - see the Ring-2 revision below, and the closing-practice doc). It rides the fallow, is never read, and is taught as a **portable skill** so the learner closes their own openings after the guide is gone. Seeded in Origin, spiraled across all three years, matched to the somatic floor. It resolves the unread-Captain's-Log question: the Log stays sovereign and unread; the learner is taught to read *themselves*. **Rule: open no faster than you teach a person to close.**

2. The layer rule - how to subtract without harm. Everything in the design is one of four layers, and cuts run top-down only: **L0 the floor / laws** (the six refusals, the safety floor, decline-with-reasoning, the un-read Log, the un-trapped exit, honest-not-manipulative) - *never cut*; **L1 the arc-grammar** (the through-lines) - *complete, never delete*; **L2 scaffolding** (how loudly the safety nets announce themselves) - *titrate to the minimum that holds*; **L3 content** (specific quests, texts, games) - *cut freely*. The four-question guide test: does removing it stop it being the Launch Pad (L0), is it the thing or its announcement (L2), does it fragment the arc (L1), else cut (L3). *"Less" aimed at the floor or the closing layer is a violation; aimed at content and accretion it is medicine.*

3. The through-line spine, all three seasons. Retrofit to every year (only the Helm had them): **name the destination on day one** (Origin -> the Unveiling; Forge -> the Call to Action; Helm -> the Council & Launch); a **carried object** (the Captain's Log is the constant; the Mantle is Helm's); and **the Vineyard - un-conscripted joy, never made useful, never harvested, never Log-prompted - seeded in Origin week one**, so it is three years old when it matters. The **Reasoning Standard** (Spock's five questions) is the connective grammar of the whole arc, learner-held, introduced at a young register in Origin and spiraled.

4. The fallow is binding, arc-wide. The fallow day, the empty basket ("nothing to declare is a true harvest"), the Vineyard, and Log-fallow-days are **precondition-to-open, as un-cuttable as the referral pathway** - the clinical counterweight to three years of an examined life. Offered with a floor, never prescribed: the over-loaded learner's *forced* fallow is honored as fully as the chosen one (Kira - un-useful joy is a class-marked luxury for some).

5. Decline-with-reasoning is a season-opening covenant, every year. "You may decline any quest; you name why; your reasoned no stands after Socratic questioning - the guide has a voice, never a veto; the question is a mirror, not a test you can fail." The one sealed exception: no Socratic mirror on the paper-system/officialdom surface, where an honest reason might disclose a legal status the guide must not know.

6. The safety floor is graduated and seeded early; scaffolding is not the floor. The somatic floor (settle -> mid-work discharge -> close-return, a standing exit ramp) is **seeded in Origin and grown**, not Helm-only - train the regulation reflex where the stakes are low. Separate the *floor's availability* (L0, held whole) from the *scaffolding signal* (L2, titrated and framed as legible trust, not vigilance). The **harden-off** (a learner meeting a hard thing un-held before launch) is *reseated* onto ordinary-stakes surfaces (the absent-guide day, the real bureaucracy call, mentor rejection), age/tenure/trauma-load gated, chosen-not-sprung - and **refused on the heaviest material**, where the floor stays whole (you do not build resilience by withdrawing the floor on grief).

7. The guide is the floor the learners stand on. Guide-sustainability is a **safety member wired in series** with every net, not a self-care footnote - held by a cross-year watch *outside* any year plan (SSC/Bashir, with Salus), with a **pre-dated honorable-defer blessing authored while rested.** A depleted guide cannot run the watch-and-pivot the whole floor depends on.

8. The runway is a gift, not a deadline. This is a three-year *emergence*, tiered: what must be true before Day 1 (Tier 0), what has Year-1 runway, and Helm-year infrastructure built cold and off the guide before Aug 2029 (the Growth Record export, mentor-track safeguarding, the named therapist). *Do not power on any run-year whose build-list still contains cold infrastructure* (Miles). And the next real step is not another review - it is one real Origin session with real learners.

(Full deliberation: `agents/meetings/2026/08/2026-08-28-{pdc,ssc,coc}-launch-pad-*.md` *and* `-leadership-launch-pad-decision-and-priorities.md` *in the evoke-agents-backup repo.)*

Ring-2 revisions (2026-08-31) - the applied buildable subset

Ring 2 (OIG infrastructure, TCC security 9/9, MAC mythic-arts 8/8) reviewed the Ring-1-applied design against the live code and the felt mythic shape. Leadership v2 (Picard/Sisko/Cura/Impetus) folded it in and closed the review body: the call does not change (the pen-and-paper pilot has zero attack surface, confirmed by all six circles); the software gates are

downstream on their own clock; the MAC buildable subset below is light, mostly relocation-and-fixing, and seeds into the Origin build. These are the design-doc edits leadership approved for application.

1. The closing practice's three lines are FIXED, and prompt 3 is rewritten (MAC/ Hoshi + Ishka). The prompts are said the same way, in the same order, at every scale, for three years - the fixed form *is* the symbol, and the repetition is what lets a learner run it alone. Prompt 3 becomes **"What's different in me now - even a little?"** (with "I don't know yet" a valid close) - the old "who am I on this side" asked the learner to certify their own transformation, the productivity reflex entering through the reflection door. **No artifact, ever** - spoken, unrecorded; the instant it has a form to fill in it becomes another opening-for-display. (Applied in the closing-practice doc.)

2. Plant the Vineyard in the Origin BUILD, not only the doctrine (MAC/Kirk + Bareil + Ishka - the most-converged MAC finding). The doctrine already seats the Vineyard in Origin week one (Ring-1 #3/#4); the *year-plan and session build* still birthed it in the Helm. The fix: name the Vineyard-thing on **Origin Session 1, Day 1, as the quiet twin of the Captain's Log** - two carried objects from morning one, the self *examined* (Log) and the self *delighted* (Vineyard, un-harvested, forever) - running as a standing thread through all three years, and *coming to fruition* (not being born) in the Helm as the natural "gift left for the room." Its un-usefulness is written as un-cuttable (as the referral pathway): the moment a guide adds a "Vineyard reflection prompt," the symbol is dead. This makes "love your life" a three-year through-line instead of a Year-3 afterthought - the whole thesis is *make the hard call **and still love your life***, and that half of the thesis must not rest on one unprotected thread in the heaviest year.

3. Seat the season-scale re-crossing on each season's last fallow day (MAC/Bareil + Chapel). The arc breathes right at the day and whole-arc scales but held its breath at the *season* scale - each season opens with a felt rite and closes with a *public harvest, which is itself an opening outward*. Seat the closing practice's season-scale prompt on the last fallow day of every season, named in each day-by-day, symmetrical to the season-opening covenant. A naming, not a new ceremony. (Applied in the closing-practice doc; day-level wording owed per season plan.)

4. "The Curious No" - the decline covenant's one rehearsed interaction primitive (MAC/Vic + Hoshi). Decline-with-reasoning (Ring-1 #5) lives or dies at the moment a learner actually says no, and that moment was unrehearsed - the session scripts kept collapsing it into *invisible opt-out* (silence, the activity continues around them), which protects the learner by *removing the encounter*. Replace the scattered opt-out phrasings with one three-beat move the guide can run under load: **(1) receive the no, whole** ("Okay. You're not doing this one." - honor *before* any curiosity, so curiosity is never a lever); **(2) offer the door once, don't push it** ("if you ever want to tell me what's behind that, I'd genuinely like to know - no rush, no owed"); **(3)**

keep them inside the encounter ("come sit with me, you don't have to do the thing"). The guide's *voice* that structurally cannot become a *veto*. Paired: the Socratic question stays a mirror, never fear-leverage ("when do you think you'll first run into this for real?", not "what happens the first time you need this and no one is beside you?"); and "the right kind of scared" is the learner's to name about themselves, never the guide's to assign. (Curious No applies here at the covenant; the Socratic-prompt fix applies in the life-admin strand.)

5. One sentence in Origin joins the two metaphor-worlds (MAC/Ishka). The Compass app ("Pillared Observatory" - you read the sky) and the Launch Pad (nautical - you steer the ship) are *one world joined at celestial navigation*: you steer the ship by the stars. Install the hinge once, in Origin, when the Captain's Log is first named alongside the Compass regions: **"The Compass is how you read your sky; the Log is how you steer - same voyage. You'll navigate by the chart you're building right now."** Without it, the Star Chart handed at the Launch reads as a graduation slide instead of the threshold-object it is. (The year-names Origin/Forge/Helm are ruled a true triad - agency *given -> forged -> steered* - and kept as-is; "two skies" stays retired in favor of the "fourth room of the same house" move-mapping.)

6. Name the daily-ritual through-line as ONE deepening muscle (MAC/Kirk). The three season rituals - Origin's **choice games** -> the Forge's **Impossible Question** -> the Helm's **Kobayashi Maru** - are presented as replacements; they are one continuous muscle (*make small choices -> stand inside questions too big to close -> make the hard call inside a no-win*), and the continuity must be *named* at each handoff or the three-year payoff goes silent. Say it plainly when each ritual begins: "it is the same muscle you have been building since Origin." (This is the through-line spine, Ring-1 #3, applied to the daily rituals; the cycle reframe in Locked-decision #1 is its companion - the keel is portable, the muscle is continuous.)

7. Protagonist-preservation is a standing check on the whole safety architecture (MAC/Kirk). The more elaborately the room is engineered to catch the learner, the more the room can quietly become the hero and the learner the fragile thing it protects. Every net is phrased as **crew, never as watch** - "a hero surrounded by a crew is still the hero; a patient surrounded by a ward is a patient." The battle-buddy is "a crew that holds each other," never "assigned to watch you flood." (Extends Ring-1 #6's scaffolding-is-not-the-floor: titrate not just the *volume* of the safety signal but its *grammar*.)

8. "Deliberately NOT built" - the infrastructure refusal architecture (Ring 2's single highest-leverage output; OIG/Chakotay + TCC/Sulu, ratified by leadership v2). The infrastructure sibling of the six refusals and the "deliberately NOT on the Floor" list. Restraint that lives only in a reviewer's head is a good intention waiting for a busy session to overwrite it; written as a refusal, it is architecture. The Launch Pad will **never** build: a **digital Captain's Log** (paper is the reference implementation of sovereignty - a notebook has no read endpoint); a **closing-practice capture surface** (#1); **in-app mentor/learner messaging** (metadata-only contact

ledger + observable transport - CC'd email or a calendared session - is the ceiling; a private channel between an adult and a minor is the thing we refuse); **any IRS / ACA / bank / payroll integration** (the real government site *is* the "do it for real"; Evoked ships kits, not pipes); **any AI in a minor's session** (the five named refusals - no AI coach/tutor, no dream-sorter, no mentor-matcher, no graded reflection, and **no AI safety-monitor of the interior**, refused on principle *and* efficacy: reading a child's private heart to "protect" them is the exact surveillance the design forbids, and the learner-commanded flag to a named human is the more protective answer; the author-time-only exception is fenced to adult-only / primary-source-checked / never live in a minor's session / never reads the interior); a **wrapped-DEK/KEK crypto envelope** at this scale ("crypto that strands a child is dishonor with good intentions" - the artifact is the key); **MFA / key-ceremony / family-key-recovery / user-managed KMS**; and **any re-engagement hook, alumni nudge, or cohort-revenue-vs-Evoked-income benchmarking, ever** (the empty exit is not negotiable under any future revenue pressure - Quark's red line joins Spock's, Tasha's, and Picard's standing markers). *The software gates that guard a real minor's record (TCC's G1-G8) are tracked in the leadership v2 decision and are the fleet's cold-build, off the guide, before software - not the pilot's, and not the operator's.*

(Full deliberation: `agents/meetings/2026/08/2026-08-29-{oig,tcc}-launch-pad-*.md`, `2026-08-31-mac-launch-pad-mythic-arts-review.md`, and `2026-08-31-leadership-launch-pad-ring2-close-decision.md` in the evoke-agents-backup repo. Guide's-nervous-system finding [six-circle convergence] and the two-clocks / gate-list live in the leadership v2 decision, not repeated here.)

"We evoke - we never extract."

The Launch Pad - The Closing Practice (the learner-held re-crossing)

A cross-year companion practice for the 16-18 studio - the one addition Ring 1 asked for Status: v0.1 working draft - builds the single element the 2026-08-28 Ring-1 review (PDC + SSC + COC) said to *add* (everything else was hold-or-cut) **Runs:** all three years (Origin / The Forge / The Helm), at three scales; introduced young in Origin, spiraled, and carried out the door at the Launch **Companions:** the three-year spec ("Ring-1 revisions"); the Reasoning Standard (Helm S2 - this practice is its emotional twin); the somatic floor; the coach-not-therapist referral pathway; the Captain's Log

> ***Why this exists.*** *Ring 1's most-converged finding, reached independently by seven structural angles: the design opens the interior faster than it closes it. The Launch Pad has world-class opening practices - 100 dreams, lineage, the worst-day autobiography, imposter work, mortality, the hard call - and, until now, only local closing (de-roling closes a scene; the glad-close closes a day). Nothing taught the learner to close the arc of what got opened, and three years of opened interior poured into a Log no one ever helps them read. This practice is the missing inverse operator.* ***The rule it serves: open no faster than you teach a person to close - and teach them to close it themselves, so the capacity leaves with them.***

What it is (in one breath)

A small, **learner-held, never-read** practice for closing an opening - three prompts, shaped as a *re-crossing* (you went somewhere; you come back changed and whole). It is the emotional twin of the Reasoning Standard: the Reasoning Standard is how a learner closes a *thought* (reason it, own the cost, honor the dissent); the Closing Practice is how a learner closes a *feeling that got opened*. It is a **portable skill**, not a worksheet the studio keeps - the entire point is that the eighteen-year-old walks out able to run it on themselves, for the rest of their life, with no guide in the room.

The practice - three prompts (a re-crossing)

After an opening - a dream named, a lineage touched, a hard call reasoned, a role stepped out of, a grief surfaced - the learner takes a quiet moment (alone, in the Log or in their head) and crosses back through three questions:

1. **What did I meet?** *(Name the thing that opened - the dream, the fear, the memory, the weight. Naming it is the first half of holding it.)*
2. **What do I carry back?** *(The elixir. It can be small; it can be "only the knowledge that I could stand in that and not be swept away." An honest "I carry back more questions than I brought" is a real answer.)*
3. **What's different in me now - even a little?** *(The change of standing, self-witnessed. "Nothing's different, and I'm steadier for having looked" is a true and complete answer - steadier is a change. And "I don't know yet" closes the practice just as honestly as a clear answer does.)*

That is it. Three lines. van Gennep's rite of passage - separation, threshold, return - compressed into something a fifteen-year-old can do in ninety seconds and a launched adult can do at a kitchen table at 2 a.m. for the rest of their life.

These three lines are fixed - said the same way, in the same order, at every scale, for three years (MAC/Ishka: a closing practice worded freshly each time is a conversation, not a symbol; the fixed form *is* the symbol, and the fixed repetition is what lets a learner internalize it as a portable instrument they can run alone). *Prompt 3 was rewritten from "who am I on this side that I wasn't on the other?" (MAC/Hoshi): the old wording asked the learner to certify their own transformation - the productivity-as-worth reflex entering through the reflection door - and recited design-register metaphor at the learner. "Even a little" pre-authorizes the small answer; "I don't know yet" makes not-knowing a passing grade, which is the surest anti-worksheet move there is.*

The three scales (close at the scale you opened - Data's rule)

An opening must be closed at its own scale. The practice runs at three:

- **Session/day scale** - the everyday close. After a Launch day's quest, or a self-guided day that opened something, the three prompts land the day. This is where the reflex is *built*, by low-stakes reps.

- **Season scale** - the harvest's private return. Every public harvest (the Unveiling, the Call to Action, the Council) is an *opening onto the social plane*; it needs a private re-crossing afterward, so the exhibited self comes back into the sovereign interior. And between seasons: a fallow integration window before the next season opens (never walk a new opening on a body still activated from the last harvest). **Decided (MAC/Bareil + Chapel, ratified 2026-08-31): seat the season-scale re-crossing on the *last fallow day of every season*, named in each season's day-by-day, symmetrical to the season-opening covenant.** This is the fix for the one place the arc still breathes wrong - it opens each season with a felt rite and closes it with a *public harvest, which is itself an opening outward*; the season door swung out at both ends. It is a *naming*, not a new ceremony (the fallow day already exists - "the season already has the fallow; give the fallow its one true sentence"): *"Before the next season opens: your closing minute at the season's scale - what did you meet this season, what do you carry, what's different in you now."*
- **Arc scale** - the Launch rite itself *is* the arc-scale closing practice: Separation -> Liminality -> Reincorporation is the three prompts made into a ceremony for the whole three years. The learner who has run the practice for three years arrives at the Launch already fluent in the move the rite performs.

The non-graduating learner needs the arc-scale close too - between seasons, not only at the Launch. Build the between-season integration fallow as the arc-scale practice for the learner who is staying.

How it is held (the invariants - these are floor, not furniture)

- **Learner-held and never read.** Like the Captain's Log, the closing practice is the learner's own. A guide never reads it for assessment. It is *how the learner reads themselves* - which is the resolution to the unread-Log question: the Log stays sovereign, and the learner is taught the practice that integrates what they put in it.
- **Rides the fallow; never a deliverable. No artifact, ever.** It lives in the fallow and the quiet, never graded, never harvested, never a thing to perform. A closing practice turned into a submitted worksheet has become another opening-for-display. **Hard rule (MAC/Ishka, ratified 2026-08-31): the practice is spoken, fixed, and unrecorded - it never acquires a worksheet, a template, or a per-session written variant.** The instant it has a form to fill in, it becomes a tenth thing that *opens* the learner for display instead of the one thing that *closes* them. (The learner may of course write in their own Log if they wish - that is theirs and never read - but the studio provides no capture surface for the practice.)

- **Portable is the point.** Teach it explicitly as a skill they keep. Name it: “this is yours to take - when you’re forty and something cracks you open, these three questions are how you come home.” The measure of success is not a good entry; it is a graduate who still uses it.
- **Introduced at a young register, spiraled.** In Origin it is light and concrete (“what did you meet in your 100 dreams today? what do you carry?”). By the Forge it deepens (closing the shadow-of-the-problem, the service exposure). By the Helm it is theirs, and it closes assisted-death allegory and *Our Town* and the Council.

What it is NOT (the boundaries)

- **It is not de-roling.** De-roling closes an *embodiment* - stepping out of a role that was never you (Helm S4 theatre; say your name, name three true things about your real life, shed the prop). The closing practice closes an opening of *the self that truly was you*. **Do not use the de-roling mechanic on real grief** (Guinan’s caution) - de-roling teaches “that wasn’t me”; grief needs “that was me, and I carry it and I am still here.” Different tools; keep the line bright.
- **It is not the Reasoning Standard.** The Reasoning Standard closes a *dilemma* (cognitive). This closes a *feeling* (affective). A learner may need both after a heavy session - reason the hard call, *and* re-cross what it stirred.
- **It is not therapy, and it does not replace the trap door.** Sometimes a close surfaces something bigger than a close can hold - a grief that won’t settle, a memory that opens a wound, a signal in the coach-not-therapist §3 list. When “what did I meet?” meets something that needs real help, the practice hands off to the **referral pathway**, warmly and without shame. The closing practice is the everyday return; the pathway is for the openings too big to close alone.

Guide notes

- **Teach it, then get out of the way.** The guide models it out loud a few times (genuinely - “what I met today, what I carry, who I am on this side”), then it becomes the learner’s private reflex. The guide’s job is to *make the space and the silence*, not to hear the answers.
- **Name the close, don’t demand the content.** “Take your closing minute” is the whole prompt. What they met and carry is theirs; the invitation to close is the only thing offered, and even that can be declined (decline-with-reasoning applies - the guide has a voice, never a veto).

- **The somatic floor carries it.** The three prompts ride on the body's return (settle -> discharge -> return). A learner who is flooded cannot re-cross cognitively; regulate the body first (K'Ehleyr's floor), then the three questions land.
- **Watch the tender openings.** After the heaviest material, the close is where a struggling learner's state can surface. Hold it as the SSC's non-invasive practice: the learner-commanded flag ("I want to talk about this") routes to care, never correction; you see the flag, never the content, unless invited.

Open items / build-forward

- **Per-session placement:** seed the explicit close into each Origin session day-by-day (light register), then the Forge and Helm sessions (deepening). Named at the plan level; the day-level wording is a further pass.
- **The between-season arc-close** for the non-graduating learner - *decided 2026-08-31: it is the season-scale re-crossing seated on each season's last fallow day (above)*. The integration-fallow window is that day; the day-level wording is a further pass per season.
- **The Salus + Jake real-learner walk** verifies the felt experience of a real close (especially the tender-opening handoff) - it is a claim about a real room, only knowable there. *(MAC/Hoshi standing condition reaffirmed: voice calibration is not verification - the rewritten prompts clear no gate until a real room hears them.)*

"We evoke - we never extract." - a container has two doors: the one you open a person through, and the one you close them through. This is the second door, put in the learner's own hand.

The Launch Pad - The Movement Floor (the settle, the way-down, the exit-ramp)

The one-page somatic grammar - the buildable form of the graduated somatic floor (P0-3) Status: v0.1 working draft - the MAC/Ring-2 deliverable (Chapel motion + McCoy soundscape, ratified by leadership v2, 2026-08-31). The floor was *named* at every scale in the spec and the year plans; this page *choreographs* it, so it can become a reflex a learner owns for life. **Companions:** the three-year spec (Ring-1 #6 graduated floor, Ring-2 #7 crew-not-watch); the closing practice (rides this floor - "the three prompts ride on the body's return"); K'Ehleyr's settle; the coach-not-therapist referral pathway.

> ***Why this exists (the finding it fixes).*** *"The somatic floor" was invoked in five documents and choreographed in none - "body-first settle" was a 25-minute scheduled block with nothing inside it. But the mechanism that makes a floor work across three years is recognition: one movement vocabulary learned so well that, by the Helm, a flooded seventeen-year-old drops into it without thinking. A settle improvised differently each guide day never becomes that reflex.* ***The three moves below are FIXED - same cadence, same anchor, same spoken cue, every guide day, Origin through Helm.*** *The sameness is not laziness; it is the medicine. Teach it in Origin S1 D2 with the closing practice's exact framing: this is yours, you're keeping it for life.*

The three moves

1. The Settle (down-regulation - opens every guide day)

A fixed, learnable sequence, not a mood. - **The organizing principle is a lengthening exhale** (the body cannot hold sympathetic arousal on a long out-breath - this is vagal, not vibes). Three shared slow breaths, the exhale visibly longer than the inhale (roughly **4-count in, 6-count out**). - **Guide-paced out loud, the same way every time**, the guide's own voice slowed to roughly a 60-bpm cadence. The consistency of the *words and pace* is the anchor. - **One stable postural anchor:** "feet flat, one hand where you feel your breath." Same anchor every day. - No device, no playlist, no soundtrack, no frequency mysticism (McCoy recanted his own 432/528Hz

folklore - the drug is rhythmic co-regulation between people, not a magic number). **The anchor is the human voice, used the same way on purpose** - free, sovereign, can't glitch, and it leaves with the graduate who can say the same words to themselves at a kitchen table at 2 a.m.

2. The Way-Down (discharge - mid-arousal, after hard work)

The move the year plans were missing. After a deep block spikes arousal (the worst-day autobiography, the Fraud Confession, an assisted-death allegory), the body is *activated* and needs to **discharge physically** - not just "close" cognitively. - **A standing physical reset:** stand, a shake-out, a short walk, a shared physical reset that moves the activation *through* the body before the room sits back down. - **Seat it in the seam between the deep block and The Table** (every session). You cannot metabolize a stress spike sitting down, and digestion is parasympathetic - an activated body cannot receive a shared meal as belonging. ~3-5 minutes. It is the difference between a body that can take the meal and one white-knuckling through it. - **Also seat it at the end of any day that ends heavy** (e.g. the Forge expedition-debrief - a body that has absorbed the world's hunger needs to come home before it drives home; do not end that day on a stakeholder map).

3. The Exit-Ramp (the standing offer to step out - and back)

Not just permission ("pass is always allowed") but a *path*. - **Where the body physically goes:** a named place to step out to, established week one ("here's where you can go, and you don't have to ask"). - **A designed re-entry:** the learner slips back in during a soft block, no acknowledgment demanded, no scene. The re-entry is choreographed so returning costs nothing. - Framed as **crew, never watch** (Ring-2 #7): the ramp is the room holding a door open, never the room watching for a fall.

The marked quiet (McCoy - silence is a designed medium, not the absence of activity)

Unstructured silence with a self-conscious teenager is *activating*, not restful - it looks like calm and feels like exposure. Every held silence in all three years (the settle, the closing minute, the Star Chart handoff, a dissent left standing) is bounded by three parts, all things the guide already has in their body: 1. **Mark the entry** - one unchanging spoken cue, the same words and slow cadence for three years: *"We're going into the quiet now."* The body learns the cue and begins to settle before the mind catches up. 2. **Floor it** - silence only lands on an already-regulated body (the

settle comes first); never use silence *as* the regulation. 3. **Bound it** - every silence has a known, cost-free way out (the exit-ramp / pass signal), so no learner is ever trapped in a silence with no door.

Protect the guide's own nervous system (McCoy + Vic - the single point of failure)

Co-regulation is a *physiological output*: the guide spends their own vagal tone to settle a flooded learner, all day, solo, with an infant worn. **The guide runs their own settle, their own way-down at day's end, and their own closing minute - as safety instrumentation, not self-care** - printed on the one-page-per-season Operating Page they carry. The guide's own regulation is on the page, or it is not in the design. (See leadership v2, the guide-in-series finding; and P0-2, the guide-sustainability watch + honorable-defer blessing.)

What is fixed vs. free

- **Fixed (never improvised):** the settle's 4-in/6-out cadence and its one postural anchor; the way-down as a standing physical discharge in the deep-block→meal seam; the exit-ramp's named place and no-scene re-entry; the marked-quiet's spoken entry cue. Same, Origin through Helm.
- **Free (guide's judgment in the room):** which day needs the way-down at the end (read the room); how long a held quiet runs; the exact walk or shake-out. The *shape* is fixed; the *dosing* is the guide's craft.

"We evoke - we never extract." - the most anti-extractive thing here is a regulatory move a young person owns for life, that needs no guide and no app. Give them the same pause, three years running, and they walk out able to come home to themselves. That is motion as medicine. That is the point.

The Launch Pad - Life Admin Strand (do-it-for-real, just-in-time)

A cross-year companion strand for the 16-18 studio - the practical "adulting" layer Status: v0.5 working draft - from the 2026-08 Europa + Cura brainstorm; pressure-tested live (v0.2-v0.4 built and hardened the strand; **v0.5 applies the ratified Ring-1 leadership fixes (2026-08-28): the Studio Commons cut to its smallest-true-thing and moved to Year 2; "the documents that are you" killed and reframed; the two-skies unification and the learner-held closing practice noted**) **Runs:** all three years (Origin / The Forge / The Helm), on the self-guided project days - a light exposure-touch on every item distributed across the three years, with deeper do-it-for-real dives pulled just-in-time and front-loaded into the launch year **Companions:** the three studio-year plans; Helm S5 "The Arena of Voices" (real adults); the Growth Record; the existing dark-shipped Compass Life Skills / Financial Literacy courses

> *This is not a course. It is the practical life-admin layer the Socratic studio work otherwise never touches - taxes, insurance, a lease, navigating officialdom - delivered the way Compass says learning actually sticks: do it for real, once, with a guide beside you, at the moment it is actually due.* ***It is not a separate world from the three seasons: it is the Reasoning Standard applied to the concrete world - the fourth room of the same house (The Doctor). A lease is a Kobayashi Maru at small scale; a phishing teardown is the Detective's 5 Whys.***

The design principle

Most life-skills curricula teach that taxes exist. The real gap is not knowledge - it is the terror of the first form, done alone, with real money on the line. That is the Compass thesis exactly: **the gap is discipline and doing, not knowledge.** Nobody stumbles because they did not know insurance existed; they stumble because the first time they had to pick a plan there was no one beside them and the stakes were real.

So the strand's whole shape is: - **Do it for real, not a class about it.** "Today we file your taxes together" beats a Financial Literacy unit every time - a real artifact, a real task, a guide beside you. - **Just-in-time, not just-in-case.** Each skill is tied to the moment it is actually needed. A comprehensive "here is all of adulthood" course glazes eyes; the same content at the moment of need sticks for life. - **Learner-pulled, guide-offered.** The learner's real life surfaces the need

(at the ~12:00 check-in); the guide offers the real task. Not pushed on a schedule. - **Exposure for all, depth by choice.** Everyone gets a light touch on every item (so no one launches never having heard of it); the deeper do-it-for-real dive is the learner's to take - or to decline *with a reasoned why* (below). No silent dodging.

The engagement model - no silent dodge (decline-with-reasoning)

The resolution to the completeness-vs-sovereignty tension, and the heart of v0.2. Two layers, one rule:

- **Exposure is non-negotiable; depth is sovereign.** Every learner *learns what each item is* (the distributed exposure-days below). Whether they then do the deeper, real dive is theirs to choose.
- **The rule: you may decline the dive, but you name why.** Not a graded checkbox and not a free pass - a *reasoned refusal*. "I've looked at this, and I'm not diving deeper because ____." This is a Kohlberg-Level-6 move; it plugs straight into the S2 Reasoning Standard (name your principle, own the cost).
- **It marries the "right kind of scared."** The reasoned "why" surfaces the difference between a genuine path-choice ("I will never drive, so car insurance is not mine to chase" - honored) and avoidance-fear ("this scares me"). If it is the right kind of scared - bigger than you, and you keep circling it - the honest naming *is* the nudge to do it anyway. If it is a real no, the reasoning honors it. Fear-as-compass, applied to the learner's own life-admin. *(Guard, 2026-08-31, MAC/Hoshi: "the right kind of scared" is the learner's to name about themselves, never the guide's to assign - otherwise it becomes the veto smuggled back in as diagnosis, the guide re-coding a reasoned no as "avoidance" to override it.)*
- **The guide has a voice, never a veto (Europa).** The guide cannot reject or overrule a learner's reasoning - they may only Socratically question it ("**when do you think you'll first run into this for real?**"). The learner's reasoned no stands after the questioning. A guide who can reject a reason has turned decline-with-reasoning back into compliance; the Socratic question is a mirror, not a gate. *(Wording fixed 2026-08-31, MAC/Hoshi: the earlier prompt - "what happens the first time you do need this and no one is beside you?" - was fear-leverage wearing a Socratic costume; its grammar forecast the learner alone and unequipped, which lands on an anxious learner as "you'll be sorry." The replacement opens the same door with curiosity instead of dread.)* The decline itself is held with **"The Curious No"** (MAC/Vic, in the spec's Ring-2 revisions): receive the no whole *before* any question, offer the door once without pushing, keep the learner in the encounter - so the Socratic mirror is never felt as a lever.

This keeps sovereignty whole (no one is forced to *do*, and no reason is adjudicated) while ensuring no one dodges out of unexamined avoidance - and it turns the readiness map from a compliance tracker into a record of *reasoned choices*.

The three triggers (how "now" gets decided)

Just-in-time only works if something reliably fires the "now" signal. Three ways a life-skill becomes due:

1. **Life-event triggered** (per-learner, asynchronous). The learner hits a real threshold and the check-in catches it: *"I got a job offer" -> this week we do your real W-4 and read your first pay stub. "We're getting an apartment" -> we read your actual lease line by line.* Got a car, turned 18, applying to college, a health scare - each pulls its task. This is the spine.
2. **Calendar-anchored** (cohort-wide, seasonal). Some things have a real clock: tax season (Jan-Apr), FAFSA (opens October), voter registration before an election, open enrollment. These become shared project-day clusters at the real moment - everyone files a return in March, once, together.
3. **Launch-anchored** (final year). The cluster *everyone* needs before they walk out, front-loaded into The Helm: the documents audit, the health-coverage transition, the full independent-living stack, the Launch-Floor sweep (below).

The "do it for real" ladder (because most learners are minors)

A 16-year-old cannot sign a lease. So "for real" scales three ways, and the guide picks the highest rung that is legal-and-real for that learner: - **Real now, any age:** open a real bank account, read a real pay stub, track a real month's budget, get a state ID, register to vote at 17.5, spot a real phishing email, cancel a real subscription, read a real Terms of Service. - **Real artifact, simulated stakes:** file a *realistic* return with the actual IRS forms and sample (or their own) numbers; walk the real ACA marketplace and price real plans; read a real lease. - **Real at the threshold:** their *actual* first-job W-4, their *actual* FAFSA, their *actual* apartment lease - done with the guide the week it lands.

Privacy floor: "do it for real" defaults to the learner's *own* real life plus realistic simulations. Family data (the family's lease, the family's taxes) is touched only with the family's consent - the learner's own bank account is theirs; the family's finances are not.

The Launch Floor - eight things, done once, before you go

The Floor is the small, non-negotiable set nobody should leave without having done *once*. Each earns its place only by clearing four bars: **high cost to stumble on, near-universal regardless of path, genuinely paralyzing the first time alone, and easy to dodge until it bites you.** Everything else stays genuinely just-in-time. The Floor is **offered as care - part of being handed the keys - never graded, never a deadline, never ranked.** "Before you go, we make sure you have touched these once, together."

1. **Your paycheck & taxes.** Read a real pay stub (gross vs net, FICA, deductions); file one real or realistic return. *(A refund means you overpaid.)* Do-it: file via Free File.
2. **Banking & credit - money you hold and owe.** Hold a real account; pull and read your own free credit report; understand how a score is built from zero and how credit-card interest compounds against you. Do-it: open/hold an account; read your real credit report.
3. **Money that grows.** Compound interest, start-early (time is the one asset an 18-year-old has), index-over-stock-picking, the employer match (free money) - and the inoculation: active trading / meme-stocks / crypto are the casino, not investing. Do-it: model your own compound-growth curve; identify a real index fund and the match on a real (or sample) offer.
4. **Health coverage.** How you are covered the day you leave, how to get covered (employer, ACA marketplace, Medicaid, a parent's plan to 26); decode premium / deductible / copay / out-of-pocket / network; urgent care vs ER. Do-it: walk the real marketplace and price a plan; map your own path.
5. **Renting.** Read a real lease line by line; tenant rights vs responsibilities; the first+last+deposit wall; renters insurance exists and is cheap. Do-it: read a real lease and flag the traps.
6. **Navigating officialdom (the paper system).** *(Renamed from "the documents that are you" - a person is not their papers; that is the state's framing, and it wounds the undocumented, foster, refugee, and trans learner. - Kira, Tier 1.)* Know how the document system works and how to navigate it at arm's length: what a birth certificate / Social Security card / ID / passport are *for*, and how the replacement/application processes work, generically. **No status disclosure, ever** - this is the most protected decline surface in the strand, and it carries **no Socratic mirror** (the honest reason for declining might be a legal status the guide must not know or infer). Build the *actually-useful* version for the learner the old framing wounded: know-your-rights, spotting notario / immigration-help scams (pair with Spot-the-Trap). Do-it (own-situation only, never required): navigate one real official process you actually need.

7. **Spot the trap.** Recognize phishing, subscription cancel-traps, predatory lending, get-rich-quick schemes, and identity theft - and know what to do when hit. *(Evoked's own home turf.)* Do-it: dissect a real phishing email and a real cancel-flow; know the fraud-response steps.
8. **The first-job paperwork & your rights.** Fill a real W-4 (and know the I-9, direct deposit); at-will employment and your basic workplace rights; read a job offer for total comp and the match; and **know your worth - ask for fair pay, negotiate without shame** (Rom - anti-extraction is not anti-prosperity; the counterweight to a wallet you're afraid to fill). Do-it: complete a real W-4; decode a real or sample offer; role-play a real pay negotiation.

The connective tissue (not a ninth item, the muscle under all eight): *make one real call to a bureaucracy* - a benefits line, the DMV, an insurer - and get an answer. That single experience dissolves the terror-of-the-form for good, and builds the meta-disposition the whole strand is really teaching: a form is just a form; you can call and ask; you can find the right person before you sign; asking for help is not shame.

Deliberately NOT on the Floor (the judgment calls)

- **Interpersonal growth / relationships / confidence / goal-setting** - off the Floor on purpose; it is the *entire three-year spine* of the Launch Pad (the Socratic, leadership, Council, Vineyard arc). Putting it on the admin Floor would both duplicate the core work and shrink something huge into a checkbox.
- **FAFSA / college enrollment** - universal *only if college-bound*; fails the "regardless of path" bar. Stays just-in-time (calendar-anchored, October).
- **Active trading / stock-picking / crypto, car-buying, entrepreneurship/LLC, travel, home-buying** - path-dependent or self-triggering; genuinely just-in-time, never Floor.
- **Government workings (civics)** - "how government is structured" is knowledge-delivery; the *practical* half (applying, the documents, the real call) is already on the Floor. See the enrichment strand below.

The just-in-time reference library (the existing courses, reframed)

The dark-shipped Compass Life Skills and Financial Literacy courses are **not** thrown out and **not** something a learner sits through. They become the **reference manual the learner opens the moment they need it**, standing beside the real task. The strand is the doing-with-a-guide; the courses are the how-to you reach for mid-doing. This gives the existing build its right role and wastes nothing.

Enrichment & path-dependent strands (real, valued - just not mandatory)

These run purely just-in-time / by interest, never as a Floor:

- **Grants & the shame-free ask.** Not Floor (path-dependent), but elevated above ordinary enrichment because it teaches the exact opposite disposition to predatory lending: *legitimate free money exists and you are allowed to ask for it*. Real do: write and submit one real scholarship or small-grant application. **Curriculum-lived:** the guide is, in real life, running Evoked's own grant search - modeling a real grant hunt is the sibling of the toddler-in-orbit lesson.
- **Government / civics, the reachable kind.** Anchored on the truth that *local government touches your life most and is the most reachable*. Real do: contact a real representative about a real issue, or sit in on one real local meeting (city council, school board). Where-your-taxes-go and local-vs-state-vs-federal ride along as context, not as a lecture.
- **The wider world of work - jobs you have never heard of.** Deliberate mind-opening: you cannot choose a path you do not know exists. Surface unusual, obscure, and unexpected careers (the person whose whole job is a thing no one at the table knew was a job). Pairs directly with S5's guest speakers - the most mind-opening visitor is rarely the doctor. Real do: each learner researches one genuinely surprising career and brings it to the cohort; the guest-speaker roster deliberately includes at least one unexpected vocation. This is joy-adjacent (Vineyard-flavored) - wonder at how many ways there are to make a life.
- **Capability & resilience (tech and signal).** The confidence-building, demystifying cluster: **keeping your technology updated** (why updates matter - it is mostly *security*; how to update devices and software) - pairs with Spot-the-trap; **the command line** (basic terminal use - the computer stops being a black box and becomes a tool you command); and **radio** (how it works, emergency and off-grid communication when the infrastructure fails -

also a perfect doorway into the wider-world-of-work). Real do: run a real update on your own device and say what it patched; run five real terminal commands; make a real contact on a radio (and meet what an amateur-radio license is).

- **The rest, on demand:** FAFSA, car-buying, investing beyond the basics, entrepreneurship/LLC, travel logistics, home-buying - opened the moment a learner's real life reaches for them.

The cross-year sequencing (the exposure-days, distributed)

Every item gets a light exposure-touch on a learner-day somewhere across the three years, so nothing is met for the first time at the launch cliff; the deeper do-it-for-real dive is then pulled just-in-time. Placement principle: earlier years get what a 15-16-year-old can act on now, the foundational, and the mind-opening; later years get the launch-critical and the legally-adult. Items that share a day are paired.

The early-trigger engine (so "across three years" is real, not a launch-year cram): the **Studio Commons** - a small, supportive shared-money practice that manufactures a real pay stub, W-4, and budget years before the outside world hands them one. *Ring-1 fix (2026-08-28): the Commons is cut to its smallest-true-thing and its launch moved to Year 2 (The Forge) - not the newborn-year Origin (see the section below). Origin now carries only the simplest real-artifact money touches (read a real pay stub, hold a real account); the shared practice begins in the Forge.*

Year	Exposure-days (paired)	Why here
Origin (Y1, ~15-16)	Paycheck + banking (simplest real-artifact touches only - read a pay stub, hold an account); Navigating officialdom; Spot-the-trap + keep-your-tech-updated; Wider-world-of-work + the command line	What a 15-16-year-old can do *now*, the foundational money habits, digital hygiene, and mind-opening - fits Origin's "who am I / what's possible"
The Forge (Y2, ~16-17)	**The Studio Commons launches here** (fund + pay-stub/W-4 machinery); Money-that-grows (fits S5 "The Long Game"); Taxes (tax season, calendar-anchored); Grants + reachable civics; First-job paperwork + rights; Radio (fits the expeditions/hands-on)	The long-game and outward-turned items - funding, systems, the working world - fit The Forge's "what is worth solving"; and by Year 2 the founding cohort has a year of trust and the child is in Tots

Year	Exposure-days (paired)	Why here
The Helm (Y3, ~17-18)	Health coverage (aging-off transition); Renting (lease, tenant rights); the **launch-year sweep** + the decline-with-reasoning conversations; deeper dives on anything not yet done for real	The launch-critical, legally-adult, threshold items - fit The Helm's "the hard call, and loving the life around it"

The pairings (items that share a learner-day because they share a muscle): Navigating officialdom + the bureaucracy call (dealing with the paper system); Spot-the-trap + tech-updating (digital hygiene/security); Money-that-grows + the first-job match (the 401k bridges them); Taxes + paycheck (your money and the government's cut); Grants + civics (the systems that fund and serve you); Wider-world-of-work + terminal + radio (the expand-what's-possible/capability cluster).

Reconciling the year plans (open item): this table is the strand's own placement; the three year-plan docs can cross-reference it rather than each re-listing the items. Editing the placement into each year plan (Origin/Forge/Helm) is a later, optional pass.

The Studio Commons - the supportive micro-economy (support, not destroy)

> ***RING-1 LEADERSHIP FIX (2026-08-28) - read this first; it governs the section below.*** *The most-converged change in the entire review (7 PDC + 8 SSC + 9 COC voices; ratified by leadership):* ***cut the Commons to its smallest-true-thing, and move its launch to Year 2 (The Forge).*** *-* ***What runs (smallest-true-thing, Year 2):*** *Layer 1 - the pooled Commons Fund (shared, stewarded) and Layer 2 - the flat civic-role stipend (the pay-stub / W-4 / year-end-tax machinery, real-artifact rung). These teach the money machinery and carry no individual-output signal, so they cannot drift to productivity-as-worth (Data's stability test).* ***The Fund is never fed by learner or family contribution****, and no shared good is ever gated on what a learner can put in (Kira - class floor). -* ***What becomes OPTIONAL, interest-pulled deepening a thriving cohort grows toward - never pre-built by the guide:*** *Layer 3 - the cooperative Micro-Venture, the learner-authored Charter, the cross-cohort inheritance, and the outward-share. "A commons a cohort asks to build is a commons; one the adults pre-assemble is an allowance with ceremony" (Guinan). The reason (Spock's tell): a structure that needed ~a dozen guards across four versions to stop teaching its own anti-lesson was*

> *fighting its own gravity - so we keep the part whose natural attractor is its purpose, and let the rest be pulled, not pushed. -* ***The detailed design below is retained as the reference for those optional deepenings*** *- what a cohort builds toward if and when they reach for it, with all its guards intact. It is no longer the Year-1 default.*

The micro-economy is the engine that makes "across three years" real, and it carries the strand's sharpest values trap: a careless "studio economy" teaches money-competence *and* quietly teaches "my worth is my output." That is the exact anti-lesson - productivity-as-worth, refusal #5. The design below is built to teach the machinery of money while teaching the opposite of extraction: that an economy can run on **stewardship and reciprocity**, and that a person's worth is never their earnings.

The governing principle: money is *a skill the crew practices together* - held lightly, the way a wrench is a tool for plumbing - never a *scoreboard that ranks its members* and never a *sacred shared object that defines the crew*. Every design choice serves that line. (Beverly's reframe: centering money as "the shared thing we steward" can quietly make money *more* central to identity, not less; the Commons is a laboratory for a skill, not a shrine.)

Three layers:

1. **The Commons Fund (shared, stewarded - the heart).** A real pooled fund the cohort stewards for shared goods: expeditions, materials, the Table, guest-speaker honoraria, a community-benefit project. Learners rotate *real* financial roles - **Treasurer** (track and reconcile the budget), **Grant-writer** (write for real money - ties to the grants strand), **Purchaser** (make real buys, read invoices/receipts), **Allocator-facilitator** (leads the deliberation on how to spend - ties to the Council/facilitation muscle). Teaches budgeting, reconciliation, real money-handling, and *allocation-as-governance* - with no individual earnings and no ranking. The money serves the crew.

2. **The Role Stipend (equal, for the machinery - the trigger).** To generate the real pay stub + W-4 + year-end tax experience, whoever holds a rotating studio role receives a **small, equal, flat stipend**. Framed out loud as a **civic-role stipend, not a wage for output** (Kasidy) - the way a juror or a board member is paid for taking a turn carrying a shared duty, not for how much they produce. That framing dissolves the "pay decoupled from work" distortion (flatness with a reason a teenager can articulate, not a rule imposed). **Rotation is real, short, and guaranteed-complete** (Beverly, Kasidy, Naomi): weeks not months, every learner reaches every role over time - because flat pay sitting on *unequal role-access* is the scoreboard sneaking back through the side door. The point is the *machinery*, never the amount, never a comparison.

3. **The Micro-Venture (optional, cooperative - the deeper lesson).** If the cohort wants to grow the Commons Fund, they may run a real *cooperative* venture (a service, a product, a stall) - cooperatively owned, proceeds to the Commons (non-proportional - no one's share tracks who "sold most"), not to individuals. Teaches revenue and cooperative economics - the anti-extraction story lived, not lectured. Optional, interest-driven. **Four guards (Kasidy, Rom, Amanda, Beverly):**
    - **Plan the free-rider grievance IN, not out.** Unequal effort with equal proceeds *will* surface ("I did all the work"); that is the lesson, not the bug. Handle it as a *facilitated deliberation* (graduated response, the Council muscle), never suppressed and never resolved with a who-did-most scoreboard.
    - **Cooperative for real, not in name.** Ownership must be *exercised* (collective choice on what the venture is, what it charges, where proceeds go), not one or two leaders deciding while the rest rubber-stamp.
    - **The sovereignty check, pointed outward (Rom - "the most Evoked move, currently absent").** Before the stall opens, the cohort runs their own venture through a kid-scaled sovereignty check: "would we be proud to explain this to the person who bought it, and to whoever supplied us?" No upsells, no dark-pattern pricing, no cutting a corner on a supplier. Cooperation-among-us must not become extraction-toward-them.
    - **Belonging is never contingent on the venture succeeding (Beverly).** If it underperforms, the frame is "cooperative economics is hard and learning includes it not working" - never "we're the cohort that couldn't." A group-worth wound is a belonging wound, and belonging is a floor, not a reward.

The values guardrails (support-not-destroy), explicit: - **Flat, equal stipends; a shared fund.** No individual earnings ranked against each other; no productivity-as-worth. - **You are not your role, and you are not your cohort's revenue (Beverly).** Named as loudly and as often as "money is a tool" - because worth leaks through the back doors flat pay doesn't cover: role-status, "best steward" esteem, venture success/failure. Disown all three out loud. - **Money is a tool, not a verdict** - and *money is also good, and earning is honorable (Rom).* Anti-extraction is not anti-prosperity. A person may want things, be ambitious, hold what they earn without shame, and ask plainly for fair pay. The sin is never having or wanting money - it is taking it from someone who did not freely give it. (Without this half, the design quietly teaches that wanting money is suspect, which produces adults who are easy to underpay. Lean on the Grants strand - the honorable individual ask - as the counterweight, and add "know your worth / negotiate without shame" to the first-job work.) - **No "best steward."** Stewardship is *witnessed, never scored, never singled out for comparative praise* (Beverly, Naomi) - praise is the vector productivity-as-worth rides in on once surveillance is banned. And *unconditional regard on failure is engineered, not hoped for:* a learner who fumbles a role is met with the same warmth as

one who excels, visibly, so the room learns worth survives a bad day. That felt experience - not the poster - is what makes “money is not a verdict” true. - **Monitoring is transparency-among-peers, never surveillance-by-authority (Amanda).** The books are open to the whole cohort; the *resource* is monitored, not the person. Nothing is reported up to the guide as a contribution-score. - **Teach the alternative economic story - and name all three (Amanda).** Market (worth = output), charity (one-directional; giver-over-receiver), mutual aid (all are both givers and receivers). Let the cohort *notice* they chose mutual aid over the other two; the noticing is the lesson. Frame the community-benefit spend as *reciprocity, not donation* - the deepest generosity still receives. - **Stewardship over accumulation** - the win is tending the shared thing well, not accumulating personally. The six refusals hold: no ranking, no productivity-as-worth, no surveillance of who “contributed most.”

What it manufactures (the whole point - real do-it-for-real, early): a real pay stub (item 1), a real W-4 (item 8), a real budget (items 1-2), real year-end taxes (item 1), real grant-writing (grants strand), real allocation/governance (civics + the Council muscle), real invoicing/purchasing - and, optionally, real cooperative revenue.

The honest operational tension (open item): *real* payroll for tiny stipends is genuine admin burden for a solo guide (withholding, filing). Two ways to hold it: run the pay-stub/W-4/tax learning on the **real-artifact rung** (the studio “runs payroll” as a real-mechanics exercise producing real forms, without full employer-payroll liability), and put **real dollars** where it is feasible (the Commons Fund, the cooperative venture). The do-it-for-real ladder already licenses this - the learning is real even where the dollars are simulated.

From pot to commons - the learner-authored Charter (Amanda)

A pooled fund the adults set the rules for is an allowance with rotating clerks. A *commons* is a community that makes its own rules for a shared resource and holds itself to them. The single change that converts one into the other: the cohort **writes (and annually amends) its own short Commons Charter** - membership, how we decide to spend, what happens when a role isn’t held (graduated, learner-designed sanctions), how we handle a fight about money, and how we amend the rules. Learner-authored, short, living; the guide facilitates, never dictates (the guide-has-no-veto rule extends here). **The charter-writing is the curriculum.** Decisions run **consent-based** (sociocratic - “can anyone *not* live with this?”) rather than majority-vote, which is the specific antidote to capture-by-the-loud: the quiet learner’s objection weighs the same as the loud learner’s enthusiasm.

Allocation-as-governance is the spine, not a parenthetical (Amanda). Deciding together how to steward a shared resource is the founding civic skill - the town meeting, the co-op, the union hall. Wire Fund allocation into the existing **Council** as a live, real-money deliberation.

Deliberation-without-stakes is a seminar; deliberation over a real shared resource is citizenship. Two lessons from one pot: the *machinery* of money rides the stipend layer; the *civics* of the commons rides the Fund layer.

The outward edge and the inheritance (Kasidy, Amanda, Naomi)

As drawn, the Fund only flows *inward* (the crew funds the crew) - which is a well-governed household budget, not yet reciprocity. Two additions make the gift real: - **An outward share.** Promote "community-benefit" from a buried spend-category to a structural, crew-decided *fixed fraction that flows out* to something the crew does not benefit from - framed as *reciprocity* (done *with* a community, receiving a relationship back), never one-directional charity. That is the moment a teenager feels the difference between spending and giving. - **The cross-cohort inheritance.** Decide it, do not default it: the Commons **inherits across years** - each cohort receives a tended fund, grows it, and hands it forward (Origin leaves for next Origin; Helm reciprocates to Forge). This completes the gift cycle across people the giver will never meet, and turns a three-year exercise into a real commons with a past and a future. (Real cost to weigh: what if a cohort depletes it? - a Charter question for the cohorts.) - **Both outward flows carry a ritual (Kasidy/Neelix)**, or they degrade into ledger lines - the handing-forward and the community gift are *felt*, not filed.

Prepare them for the real market, not only the garden (Rom)

A learner who only ever experiences a warm, flat, cooperative commons walks into an at-will, sometimes-extractive market with a map of a country that does not exist. So the Commons models the better economy **and rehearses the real one, named as two different games.** Stage one guided encounter with a *non-cooperative* counterparty - a supplier who won't budge, a predatory contract for the venture to read and refuse, a manipulative sales flow to spot - with the guide beside them (the strand's own thesis). Then name it plainly: *"The Commons is how we choose to run our economy. Out there, most are not run this way. Your job is not to be shocked - it is to survive it with your sovereignty intact, and to build the better kind wherever you can."*

The vulnerable learners (Beverly - non-negotiable)

- **The financially-strained learner.** Money-as-shared-sacred-object can activate a teenager whose family cannot make rent; and the small stipend that is a *toy* to an affluent learner may be a *lifeline* to a poor one - which reintroduces the very meaning-differential flat pay was meant to erase. So the **stipend stays on the real-artifact rung (simulated dollars, real forms), never real income a learner relies on**; real dollars live only in

the collective Fund and venture. A quiet, private opt-down exists. “Money is just a tool” is never said carelessly to a room that may hold someone for whom it has never once been just a tool.

- **The productivity-bound learner.** The perfectionist whose worth already requires proof will read the Commons as a fresh, morally-sanctioned arena to perform in (flawless stewardship, grants that land). Their tell is *over*-engagement, not disengagement. Screen for them before the Commons runs; for them it is watched, not just offered (Salus + Jake + Beverly define the watch-fors); the therapeutic move is witness-before-fix and making it explicitly safe to be an unremarkable steward.

The drift watch (Naomi - the Commons is the one drift-capable object)

The Commons is a live system with its own gravity; its drift is *dormant until success* - it wakes exactly when the program is thriving and everyone is celebrating. Guard and monitor: - **A group-level anti-scoreboard guard** (the biggest unguarded gap): no Commons is compared to another Commons or to its own past; the venture is measured only against *the cohort’s own stated intention* for its fund, never a number to beat. - **Tripwires** (first instance = a watch; the pattern = a breach): rotation eroding (“they’re good at it, keep them”); the stipend spoken of as *earned/owed* rather than the pay-stub lesson; praise of the “best steward”; the venture consuming time disproportionate to its learning, or becoming a bar to sustain; any cohort-vs-cohort comparison. - **The founder-pressure line (named plainly):** the children’s cooperative is **not a business unit.** Its revenue must never, even for a moment, be looked at against Evoked’s own income gap. If that line ever blurs under founder-pressure, that is the drift, and it gets named without softening.

Review outcome (2026-08-26, five voices)

Reviewed by Kasidy (reciprocity), Amanda (commons), Rom (cooperative economics), Beverly (psyche), Naomi (Living Seed / drift). **Unanimous: BUILD, with conditions** - all the conditions above are folded into this v0.4. Two process gates remain binding before it runs with real learners: (1) **the consented real-learner walk of *this surface*** - Beverly + Salus + Jake watching the productivity-as-worth guard in an actual room, because it is a claim about felt experience only verifiable there; and (2) the guide-capacity check on the real-vs-realistic-payroll load (below).

Real adults (plugs into Helm S5)

The strand is the natural home for the S5 real-adult work: a real accountant walks tax day; a tenant-rights person walks lease-reading; a careful (non-sales) insurance person walks health coverage; an unexpected vocation opens the wider-world-of-work strand. **Balance the roster (Rom):** alongside the anti-extraction voices, include at least one *honorable-prosperity* voice - someone who says plainly "I love my work, I am well paid for it, and there is no shame in that" - so the strand does not teach anti-extraction as anti-prosperity. All under the gates already designed - Riker's safeguarding (guide present / observable channel / vetting proportional to access) and Kasidy's reciprocity (real honoraria, the story is a gift never the price, close the loop).

The readiness map (completeness without a deadline)

The honest tension: pure just-in-time risks a learner launching having never triggered "taxes" or "health coverage." The fix is **not** a graded checklist (that violates the six refusals). Instead:

- A **learner-owned readiness map** - a menu of the real-world tasks (Floor + just-in-time + enrichment), that the learner drives as life triggers them. Lives in the Compass Life Skills tab; feeds the Growth Record; the Captain's Log holds the reflection. It is a *map they own*, not a compliance tracker the guide checks off - and under the v0.2 model it records **reasoned choices** (done / did-with-a-guide / declined-because-____), not pass/fail.
- The **launch-year sweep** confirms every Floor item has been *met at the exposure layer* and invites the deeper dive, gently ("what is still unopened?"), never as an audit, a deadline, or a grade. A learner may decline a dive - with their reasoning - and that reasoned "no" is honored. That is how sovereignty and a real floor coexist: the floor guarantees the *exposure and the offer*, the learner owns the *depth*.

Keeping it current (the maintenance problem, turned into a lesson)

This is the one strand whose content rots - tax forms, ACA rules, the FAFSA (mid-overhaul), marketplace URLs, benefit thresholds. A "do it for real" strand that teaches last year's form is worse than none, because it teaches *wrong* with false confidence. Two defenses, and the second is the better one:

- **A named currency owner + an annual sweep.** Someone owns a check of the do-it-for-real kits before each tax/FAFSA/enrollment season. A learner cannot be the only line of defense on whether the form is right.

- **The learner-update-check, as a taught skill (Europa).** When an item is presented, the learner runs an *update-check* - "is this form / rule / number still current, and how would I verify it?" This does double duty: it keeps the content honest *and* teaches the meta-skill of verifying currency - which is exactly the discipline Evoked holds for itself (research-currency, before you rely on a claim). Learning to check whether your information is current - and learning to update your own technology - are life skills in their own right, not overhead.

The currency-check argues for **keeping the Floor small (eight) and resisting the urge to grow it** - every added item is another thing that rots.

Six-refusals compliance

No grades, no ranking, no banking-model deposit, no external deadline, no productivity-as-worth, no surveillance. The Floor is offered as care; the readiness map is learner-owned; the sweep is an invitation, not an audit. The one thing asked of everyone is *exposure* (learn what each thing is) and, if declining the deeper dive, a *reasoned why* - which is an exercise of judgment, not a compliance gate. A learner who reasons their way to "not this, not now, and here is why" has exercised sovereignty exactly as designed.

Preconditions & open items

1. **Build the readiness map** in the Compass Life Skills tab (learner-owned; feeds the Growth Record; not a graded tracker).
2. **Assemble the do-it-for-real kits** - the Free File walkthrough, the ACA-marketplace walk, a sample lease, a sample job offer, a real phishing/cancel-flow teardown, the documents-audit checklist, the compound-growth model.
3. **The real-adult roster** for tax day / lease / insurance / unexpected vocations - under the S5 safeguarding + reciprocity gates (Riker, Kasidy; George for outreach and honoraria).
4. **Legal-for-minors pass** - confirm which "real" tasks a minor can do independently vs. which need the real-artifact/simulated rung or family consent.
5. **The privacy line** - own-data default; family data only with family consent.
6. **Sequencing table** - built (above); the open piece is the optional pass to cross-reference it into each year-plan doc.
7. **The Studio Commons (Ring-1 fix applied):** build only the **smallest-true-thing** - the pooled Fund + the flat civic-role stipend / pay-stub-W-4 machinery - and **launch it in Year 2 (The Forge)**, not Origin. The cooperative venture, the Charter, the inheritance, and the outward-share are **optional deepenings a thriving cohort grows toward, never pre-built** (detailed design retained above for that case). Fund never fed by learner/

family contribution. Remaining before real learners: (a) the consented **real-learner walk of this surface** (Beverly + Salus + Jake); (b) stipend stays on the real-artifact rung (real forms, simulated dollars), real dollars only in the Fund; (c) the venture/Charter/inheritance questions are deferred until a cohort reaches for them.

8. **The currency owner + annual sweep** - name who checks the do-it-for-real kits before each tax/FAFSA/enrollment season; wire the learner-update-check into how each item is presented.
9. **The capability/resilience kits** - the update-check walkthrough, a terminal starter set, and the radio lesson (and whether to pursue an amateur-radio license as the do-it-for-real).

"We evoke - we never extract." - the world is bigger than the ten jobs a teenager has heard of, and the first tax form is only terrifying once. Do it for real, together, at the moment it is due.

The Coach-Not-Therapist Referral Pathway

How the guide notices, holds, and routes clinical material - without treating it
Status: v0.1 - the binding gate before Session 5 runs with a real learner **Companions:** studio-year-plan v0.3 (Part 6); The Guide's Own Floor; Session 5 day-by-day; life-coaching evidence brief

> *This is the "trap door" every session's caveats point at. The guide is a life-coach and mentor,* ***not a licensed clinician.*** *Sessions surface identity work, memory, grief, and hard days by design; clinical material will come up. The guide's job is not to treat it - it is to* ***recognize it, hold the moment safely, and route it to real help, fast.*** *A trauma-informed floor with an unbuilt trap door is not trauma-informed. Build this before opening.*

1. The boundary (scope of practice)

The ICF standard is the professional floor and it is clear: **a coach does not diagnose, does not treat mental-health conditions, and refers when signs indicate a learner is hampered by emotional/clinical issues beyond coaching.** (ICF: Referring a Client to Therapy)

- **Coaching can:** hold space, witness, ask, support awareness, reflection, action, and accountability.
- **Coaching cannot:** diagnose, treat, counsel through trauma, or manage a mental-health crisis. Those require a licensed role the guide does not hold.
- **The move when it's past coaching:** acknowledge the limit honestly, hold the moment, and route. Routing is not failure - it is competent care.

2. Name the limit of confidentiality UP FRONT (Day 1)

Transparency is care (and it's the honest floor). At the start of the year - woven into the Two-Way Deal - the guide says plainly what stays private and the one thing that cannot:

> *"Almost everything you write and say here is yours and private - your Captain's Log, no one reads it to judge you. The one thing I can't keep private is if you're in danger, or someone is hurting you. Then my job is to help you get real help, and I will. That's not breaking trust - it's what care actually looks like."*

Say it before it's ever needed. A confidentiality limit disclosed in the moment feels like betrayal; disclosed up front, it's a promise kept.

3. Recognize: when it's past coaching (route, don't coach)

Signals that mean **route now**, not "work it in a session": - Any mention of **suicide, self-harm, or wanting to not be here.** - Disclosure of **abuse, neglect, or someone hurting them** (see the mandatory-report duty, §5). - **Acute crisis** - panic, dissociation, a flashback, can't-be-reached distress. - **Disordered eating** signals (this is why Wellness is HOLD-FOR-HUMAN). - **Substance crisis**, or **threats to others.** - Signs of a **mental-health condition** beyond ordinary distress (persistent, impairing).

When in doubt, route. You do not have to be sure. Certainty is the clinician's job, not the coach's.

4. The in-the-moment container (what to actually do)

- **Stay with the learner. Never leave a learner in crisis alone.**
- Move to the **designated quiet space** (name and prepare it before opening - a real room/corner, not a hallway).
- **Be present, calm, and listening. Do not fix, do not probe for details, do not counsel.** Presence, not treatment.
- **Do not promise secrecy you can't keep** (see §2).
- **The honest limit, named:** a solo guide with a worn baby has finite capacity to hold a breakdown *and* the room at once. That limit is real, not a failing. It is exactly why the whole-absence bench exists - if you cannot hold both, that is a moment to call the bench adult, a parent, or a crisis line. Naming the limit is safer than pretending it away.

5. The two duties you cannot coach around (Idaho)

(a) Imminent danger to self or others. Call **988** (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline - call, text, or chat; 24/7; free; the Idaho Crisis & Suicide Hotline routes through 988). If life-threatening, **call 911** or go to an emergency department. (988 Lifeline; FCC 988)

(b) Mandatory reporting. In Idaho, **everyone is a mandatory reporter** - the guide included. Suspected **abuse, neglect, or abandonment** of a child must be reported, ideally **within 24 hours.** You do **not** need proof - report the concern and let the professionals decide. (Idaho DHW; RAINN Idaho summary) - **Statewide:** 855-552-KIDS (855-552-5437) - **Treasure Valley:** 208-334-KIDS (208-334-5437) - Or **2-1-1** (Idaho Careline), or local law enforcement. - This duty **overrides the Log's privacy** - which is exactly why §2 names the limit on Day 1. *(Note: if the parent/guardian is the source of harm, this is a report, not a parent call - see §6.)*

6. Parent / guardian involvement

- For a minor's safety concern, the **parent/guardian is generally looped in**, with care for the learner's dignity and only what safety requires.
- **The exception:** where the parent/guardian *is* the concern, do **not** call them - that is a mandatory report (§5b). Route to DHW / law enforcement instead.

7. The referral roster (build it REAL before opening - names, not categories)

Confirm every number/name is current before the year opens; some change.

Need	Resource
Suicide / crisis (self or others)	**988** (call/text/chat, 24/7); **911** if life-threatening
Crisis text	**Crisis Text Line** - text to **741741**
Idaho youth crisis center (voluntary, free, ages 5-17)	**Clarvida Youth Support Center, Boise** - 833-527-4747 (1-833-5-CRISIS) (Idaho YES)
Mandatory abuse report	855-552-KIDS statewide / 208-334-KIDS Treasure Valley / 2-1-1 / law enforcement
A named, warm-referral therapist	**[BUILD THIS: 1-2 local licensed clinicians the studio can warm-refer to - a real name and number, arranged before opening]**

Need	Resource
General info/referral	**2-1-1** Idaho Careline; SAMHSA National Helpline 800-662-4357

The **named therapist line is the one that must not stay blank.** “Route to real help” is only real if there is a real person to route to. Arrange it before the year opens.

8. After: the guide’s own debrief

Holding a hard moment costs the holder. Per **The Guide’s Own Floor**: after any safety event, **debrief with a supervisor or peer - do not carry it alone.** Document the incident **factually and minimally** (what happened, what you did, who you contacted) - never the learner’s private content. Coach-not-therapist protects the learner; the debrief protects the guide.

The gate (binding)

Session 5 does not run with a real learner until: 1. This pathway is **built** - the quiet space designated, the roster filled with **real names and current numbers** (especially the named therapist), and the Day-1 confidentiality script ready; **and** 2. The **consented Salus + Jake real-learner walk** is done.

Sources

- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline: https://988lifeline.org/ ; https://www.fcc.gov/988-suicide-and-crisis-lifeline
- Idaho mandatory reporting (DHW): https://healthandwelfare.idaho.gov/services-programs/children-families-older-adults/child-and-family-services-and-foster-care-3 ; https://apps.rainn.org/policy/policy-state-laws-export.cfm?state=Idaho&group=4
- ICF referral / scope of practice: https://coachingfederation.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/12/icf-research-guide-referring-client-to-therapy.pdf
- Idaho youth crisis resources: https://yes.idaho.gov/crisis-resources/ ; https://idahocrisis.org/resources

“We evoke - we never extract.” Care that knows its own limit, and routes past it without shame, is the most evoked thing a coach can do.

The Guide's Own Floor

The trauma-informed floor the learners get (Session 5), applied to the guide who holds them Status: v0.1 - from Cura's "one change" in the 2026-08-23 evoked-alignment review **Companion to:** studio-year-plan v0.3 (Part 6); all session day-by-day docs

Why this exists

The year's deepest claim is that you can run your own life sustainably and author it without extracting from yourself. The single most powerful teaching instrument in the whole year is **the guide modeling that they do not extract from themselves to serve.** A guide who runs themselves into the ground to deliver the founding year would be, however lovingly, teaching the opposite of the curriculum with their own body. Teaching "run your own ship" from a ship you are sinking to keep afloat is the deepest possible incoherence.

The studio has a trauma-informed floor for the learner (Session 5: opt-out, private-by-default, name-without-detailing, coach-not-therapist). It has had **no equivalent floor for the guide.** This is that floor. It is not a concession to circumstances. It is the curriculum, applied to its teacher.

(Written for the specific reality: Erin runs this solo, with a ~3-month-old worn, in the founding year, while also mothering and holding a household. The fleet's standing observation - that Europa extends care to everyone more completely than to herself - is exactly what this document exists to interrupt.)

The floor

1. The pre-committed pause-trigger - N = 2

If the deep Socratic block has been **pivoted away for 2 consecutive guide days** (baby, exhaustion, a hard week), the studio **pauses to fallow-mode and re-plans** rather than pushing through. Not a judgment call made while depleted - a **pre-committed rule set now, while rested.** A depleted person does not pause; that is exactly when the pause-instinct fails. N=2, not an undefined N, and not 4.

2. Witness-debrief - more often than monthly

Sessions 5 and 7 ask the guide to be the container for teenagers' turning points, worst days, family ruptures, grief, and self-portraits. That is real emotional labor, and it lands on the same body doing the newborn's night-holding and the household's holding. **The coach-not-therapist boundary protects the learner; it must also protect the guide.** The guide needs a real reflective/debrief structure - a supervisor, a peer, a trusted practitioner - **more often than monthly through S5 and S7**, so they have somewhere to set down what they witness. Monthly is not enough for the witness-load of the memory season.

3. Permission, in writing: pivoting is the design working

A pivoted-away deep block is not a failure of the founding cohort. A good-enough Tuesday in December is not a betrayal of the lineage. The year is called **Origin, not Mastery.** The permission the learners get - "a permanent-scaffold path is legitimate," "postpone depth, never fake it" - **the guide takes for themselves.** Write it down so it is a rule, not a feeling you have to summon while tired.

4. The founding-cohort trap, named

"The founding cohort is the lineage - get it right" is wise about enrollment. It is a trap if it quietly raises every ordinary day to "I must get this right" in the year you have the least margin. Offer yourself the reframe you would offer a learner: **Origin is the year of claiming the whole, not shaping it perfectly.** Good-enough, sustained, beats excellent-then-collapsed.

5. The coach-not-therapist referral pathway - built, and it protects both

This is the trap door under the whole year, and it is currently "owed" in every session. It must be **built before Session 5 runs**, because S5 surfaces worst-days and grief by design. Built means concrete: - **An in-the-moment crisis container:** a designated quiet space; who a crying 16-year-old actually goes to; and the honest limit that a solo guide with a worn baby has finite capacity to hold a breakdown - named, not pretended away. - **A clinical hand-off:** the named licensed professional / route for anything past what a coach can hold. - This pathway protects the learner *and* the guide - it is the guide's floor too, because "hold this alone" is not a plan.

The gate

Session 5 does not run with a real learner until (a) this referral pathway is built and (b) the consented Salus + Jake real-learner walk is done. A trauma-informed floor with an unbuilt trap door is not yet trauma-informed. This is a gate, not a caveat.

The one-line version

“We evoke, we never extract” - and the person most often left off that sentence is the guide. Build their floor before the seventh session.

Launch Pad entry thresholds (v1) — ready-to-apply spec

Date: 2026-07-20. **Status:** ratified by Europa. **For the wheel session to land** (`studios.js`, `thresholds.js` are its change surface). **Origin:** Adventure Thresholds PDF pattern + Launch Pad three-year-story-cycle plan + the Growth Record. **Keystone:** Launch Pad entry (16) **is** the record's "take the wheel" (16 = learner-held custody) — one crossing.

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1. Entry gate → 16

- `studios.js`: `STUDIO_ENTRY_AGE.launchpad: 15 → 16`.
- Age-gate copy (existing pitch `ask-age` stage, `pitchCutoff`): *"will you have turned 16 by [cutoff]?"* (auto from `entryAge`).
- **Note (Europa aware):** the Launch Pad plan says "ages 15-18"; a 16 entry gate makes the studio start at 16. Intended.

2. The design shift (why Launch Pad inverts Adventure's weight)

Adventure entry (~11) was **WORLD-heavy** — *academically ready + heroic mindset?* Launch Pad entry (16) is **MAKING + VOICE-heavy** — *can you self-direct, make real things, mentor, and author your own story and record?* Academics are assumed; the question is **agency and output.** VOICE (the center) goes from one Adventure item to the heart of the crossing.

3. The thresholds (region order: World → Making → Others → Self → Voice)

Ids use the `lp_` prefix (mirrors `adv_`). Region is the four-region home; each is a goal a learner works toward and marks with a guide, never a graded score.

WORLD — self-directed learning

- `lp_self_paced` — **Self-paced mastery, teach-it-back.** Set your own pace on core academics; prove it by teaching it back.

- `lp_socratic` — **Lead a Socratic discussion** on a Deep Book (not just attend) — think out loud, in public.
- `lp_synthesis` — **One research synthesis** — an essay/presentation that compares and argues. The "think for yourself" muscle.

MAKING — real output + portfolio (the Launch Pad differentiator)

- `lp_portfolio` — **A portfolio piece worth showing** — one advanced output *you'd show a future employer or program*. Seeds the record's **Portrait view** directly.
- `lp_real_project` — **A real project, delivered** — take one thing idea→finished and shown (or commit to the apprenticeship path).

OTHERS — leadership matures to mentorship

- `lp_mentor` — **Mentor a younger learner** (a Discovery learner) — weekly, bring something useful.
- `lp_lead_quest` — **Design + lead a Quest** — recruit a team, hold the question, run the exhibition.

SELF — self-governance + tending the life

- `lp_own_day` — **Run your own day** — sustained self-direction / contract mastery (the 9-1:30 self-directed rhythm; Adventure's "Soaring," elevated).
- `lp_tend_life` — **Tend the life around the work** — honor rest/hearth as practice (never earned), and name how you care for yourself. *"Love the life around it."*

VOICE (center) — author your own story

- `lp_know_story` — **Know your story** (the Origin expedition) — a reflection/pitch: who am I, what's worth solving *to me,* what I'd offer the world.
- `lp_take_wheel` — **Take the wheel of your record** — own and author your Captain's Log / Growth Record. **This IS the 16 = product-control handoff.** The keystone threshold where the two projects meet.

4. Ready-to-apply data shape

Model on `THRESHOLDS.adventure`. Under the four-region model, attach each to its region (World/Making/Others/Self/Voice) rather than the legacy skills/character split — but if the current structure still needs it, WORLD+MAKING ≈ `skills`, OTHERS+SELF+VOICE ≈ `character`.

```
THRESHOLDS.launchpad = {
  entryAge: 16,
  skills:    [ lp_self_paced, lp_socratic, lp_synthesis, lp_portfolio, lp_real_project ],
  character: [ lp_mentor, lp_lead_quest, lp_own_day, lp_tend_life, lp_know_story,
lp_take_wheel ],
}
THRESHOLD_LIFE_AREA.launchpad (→ region under COMPASS_V2):
  lp_self_paced, lp_socratic, lp_synthesis   -> World
  lp_portfolio, lp_real_project              -> Making
  lp_mentor, lp_lead_quest                    -> Others
  lp_own_day, lp_tend_life                     -> Self
  lp_know_story, lp_take_wheel                 -> Voice
```

5. Flow (already correct)

The pitch/age-gate step is inserted before `within_1yr` in the onboarding cascade (`steps.splice(indexOf('within_1yr'), 0, 'pitch')`), so it is offered at the age gate before the one-year reflection. Once `getThresholds('launchpad')` is non-null, the Adventure→Launch Pad pitch turns on (today it is suppressed because launchpad thresholds are null). The thresholds pre-place into the region slices in the World→Making→Others→Self→Voice order.

6. Coordination

`studios.js` + `thresholds.js` are the wheel session's change surface. Land this there (additive: a new `launchpad` key). No conflict with the region re-map — this is new-studio content, not a remap of existing ids. Composes with the `regionIdForCategory` shim.

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v1, ratified 2026-07-20. Adventure asks "are you ready?" of an 11-year-old; Launch Pad asks "will you take the wheel?" of a 16-year-old — and the wheel is their own record.

The First Conversation - Launch Pad founding cohort (2027-2028)

Status: v0.1 working draft, authored 2026-09-24 from the 8-voice fleet meeting (Jake Sisko, Naomi Wildman, Pavel Chekov, Kira Nerys, Ibn Khaldun, Comes, Accord, Cura). Written now; **first use after the pilot morning has been watched**; revised from the first real family conversation. **Companions:** `2026-06-24-launch-pad-three-year-story-cycle-v0.1.md` (the spine), `2027-2028-launch-pad-studio-year-plan-v0.3.md` (the operating plan), `launch-pad-STATUS-AND-HANDOFF.md` §5-6 (the one-page Family note and the access statement this composes with). **Minutes:** `evoke-agents-backup/agents/meetings/2026/09/2026-09-24-launch-pad-first-cohort-conversation-questionnaire.md`

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0. What this is, and is not

This is the conversation a family and the Launch Pad have before either says yes. It is **not an interview, an audition, or a test.** It has three honest jobs, and only three:

1. Does the family understand what this is and what it is not?
2. Is the learner's yes their own?
3. Can the guide honestly hold this learner, within the limits the access statement states?

It produces no score, no rank, no grade. If more than seven learners fit, that is a real problem and it is handled in §7, by a stated method, never by ranking people.

Sequencing. Nothing here runs before three things exist: the one-page Family note (what this is / is not, how you leave, how removal works), the **access statement** (what one guide with an infant can hold and cannot provide), and these fit signs, published to families in plain language. A conversation held before the access statement exists becomes invisible screening. That is the whole Ring-3 finding, and it binds.

Not before the pilot. The one real Origin morning (2-4 teens, the 100 Dreams, Salus and Jake in the room) is where the fleet learns whether the guide can meet a no. Use this after that morning has been watched.

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1. Before the conversation - what the family receives

Sent with the invitation, in plain language (aim for eighth grade), translated or with an interpreter offered when the household's first language is not English:

- **The one-page Family note.** What the Launch Pad is (a three-year studio, pen and paper, one guide, a small room) and is not (not therapy, not accredited, not a school with grades). How you leave. How removal works and who can appeal it. The six refusals, as a promise the family can hold us to.
- **The access statement.** Honestly: one guide, an infant worn on guide days, no aide, no speech or occupational therapy, self-managed Monday and Wednesday mornings. What the room can hold. What it cannot. Who we would warmly point you toward if we cannot.
- **The fit signs (§2)**, so "fit" is never a private judgment.
- **The mode menu (§3.1)**, so the family chooses how the conversation happens.
- **This sentence, verbatim:** *"Pass is always allowed. Any question you don't want to answer, you skip, and nothing is owed."*

1.1 Language (Kira's ruling, 2026-10-13)

A household's first language is an access question, not a fit question. It is never read against the fit signs and never enters the guide's notes.

- **The programme provides and pays for an interpreter** at the family conversation and at the learner's own yes, in any language the household asks for. A family is free to bring their own instead, and that costs nothing and means nothing.
- **The learner never interprets their own admission conversation.** Not for a parent, not for a sibling, not "just for this part."
- **No family member is pressed into interpreting either.** If a relative offers and the family wants that, fine. Nobody is asked.
- **The reason, on the record:** a sixteen-year-old translating *"is this what you want?"* to her own mother cannot answer it. The seventh promise says your no is real. Spoken through a child's own mouth, to the person they are answering about, it is not. Boise seats resettled families; this will arrive, not might.
- Written materials reach the family in their language, or an interpreter walks them through each one aloud before anything is signed. **No countersignature is taken on a document the signer could not read.** That binds the Family note and the Family Charter.

Recruitment posture (from Ring 3): **invitation, not persuasion.** Recruit on the design and the refusals. Show the room, not a child. No urgency, no scarcity. Promise the conditions, never the outcome.

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2. What we are looking for - eight fit signs, each yes/no, never ranked

Written as what it looks like and what it is not. The guide reads for these; the guide never scores them.

#	Sign	What it can look like	What it is NOT
1	**A live question, or a thing already in motion**	A dream said out loud; a problem that will not leave them alone; something they are already making, running, fixing, caring for	"Knows what they want." A settled answer at sixteen is data about where they are, not a strength. The devout learner's "I am here to be faithful, not to examine" is a valid answer to this sign
2	**Something done that nobody required**	A rabbit hole they went down; a skill they taught themselves; a job, a sibling, a kitchen, a garden they hold because someone had to	Enthusiasm performed for adults; a resume
3	**Can say no to an adult**	Disagrees with the guide in the room and survives it; says "I don't want to do that one" when offered a real out	Compliance; the fast yes; charm
4	**Can be witnessed and can witness**	Listens when someone else tells a story; can stand a little discomfort at being seen	Confidence; volume. The quiet witness counts fully

#	Sign	What it can look like	What it is NOT
5	**A relationship to rest**	Can name what they do when nothing is required; or honestly says "I can't stop," which the guide needs to know	Productivity; a full calendar as proof of seriousness
6	**A family that can hold the covenant**	Parents who hear "no progress channel, no guide on demand, no comparing children" and can say what that will cost them	A family that agrees fast
7	**Access needs the room can hold, or warmly refer**	"What helps you learn, what gets in the way," answered honestly and read against the access statement	"Fit." If the honest answer is "we cannot hold this," the family hears that and a real referral, in writing
8	**The learner's own yes**	Given a week later, alone, without a parent in the room, in any medium	The parent's yes in the child's voice, on the same afternoon

Signs 1-5 are the learner's. Signs 6-7 are the family's and the guide's. Sign 8 is the learner's alone, after.

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3. The learner conversation

Who is in the room: the learner, the guide, and a second adult (pilot default: Salus or Jake; see §8 for when the second adult leads). The second adult is not there to score. They are there to be able to say afterward, "you were managing that no, not meeting it."

Length: about 45 minutes. Shorter is fine. The learner ends it whenever they want.

Record: paper notes by the guide against §2 only. No recording. No transcript. The second adult reads the notes and countersigns them. The notes are shown to the family on request.

3.1 The mode menu (the family chooses; the learner can change their mind on the day)

- At a table, in the studio room, with tea and something to eat

- On a walk, outside
- With a parent in the room, or with a parent in the next room
- Written questions sent a week ahead; the learner answers in writing, drawing, voice memo, or brings them to talk through
- Spoken, written, drawn, signed, or with an interpreter

Bring one thing, if you like (never required): an object, a page you wrote, a drawing, a song, a photo, a thing you made. It gives you somewhere to start that isn't words.

No homework. Nothing is assigned before enrollment. "Bring one thing if you like" is an offer with a real pass, not a task.

3.2 The shape (mirrors a guide day, so the learner meets the actual thing)

Arrival. Sit, eat, no agenda for a few minutes. The guide says the pass sentence out loud: *"Pass is always allowed. Skip anything. Nothing is owed."*

The settle. Thirty seconds, feet on the floor, look around the room, one breath. The same settle that opens every guide day. Offered, not required.

The questions. Below. Pick from them; do not run them all. The guide holds questions, not answers.

A taste. Ten minutes of the real thing: one impossible question held Socratically ("Could one person change a system?" or one the learner brings), or one choice game from Session 3. The learner sees what a morning is like, and the guide sees whether the learner can say "I don't know" and whether they can disagree.

The out. Somewhere in the taste, the guide offers something the learner can decline right there: *"Here's a part of this you can say no to right now, and I'd like to see you do it if it isn't yours."* Sign 3 is read here, not in the answers.

Close. *"Anything you want to ask us? Anything you want to tell us that we didn't ask?"* Then: what happens next (§5), and the sentence *"you don't have to decide anything today."*

3.3 The questions

How to ask them. One question, then stop. Count to five before you say anything else. Do not stack examples onto a question: the examples are you answering it for them, and a sixteen-year-old hears that as the adult being nervous. Never run all of these; pick the ones the conversation opens. "I don't know" is a complete answer, and so is a shrug.

The pass sentence is said once, at the start, so it does not have to be repeated into every question.

Opening - What did your family tell you this is? - What do you think it is? - What do you want to ask me?

A live question (sign 1) - What can't you stop thinking about? - Do you know what you want to do with your life? - If yes: How did you land on that? - If no: Most people don't. This year is built for that. - What are you here to be faithful to? *(for the learner whose frame is faith, family, or duty)*

Something nobody made you do (sign 2) - What have you learned that nobody made you learn? - What's the last rabbit hole you went down? - What are you responsible for at home?

Saying no (sign 3) - When was an adult wrong and you knew it? - What did you do? - What did a teacher or a parent want from you that you didn't give? - *(Sign 3 is read live in the taste, not from these answers.)*

People, and being alone (sign 4) - When someone tells you something hard, what do you do? - Six or seven people, one room, three years. What's good about that? - What's hard about it? - When do you need to be alone? - What happens when you can't be?

Rest (sign 5) - What do you do when nothing is required of you? - Is stopping easy or hard for you? - Fridays here never get filled. What do you think of that?

The mornings you run - Mondays and Wednesdays, the morning is yours. What would you do with it? - What would make it go wrong?

How you work (sign 7, in the learner's own words) - What helps you learn? - What gets in the way? - How do you like to get your thoughts down? - What would make this room hard for you?

Close - What haven't I asked that you wish I had? - What would make you say no to this?

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4. The family conversation

Who: the parents or guardians, the guide, the second adult. About 30 minutes. The learner may sit in or not, their choice.

What we say, plainly: - What this is and is not (the Family note, again, out loud). - The access statement, out loud, with the honest sentence: *"One guide, an infant on guide days, no aide. Here is what I can hold. Here is what I can't. If I can't, I'll say so and point you somewhere real."* - The exit and removal: how you leave any time; that removal is a written, witnessed act with an appeal path that is not the guide. - The Table covenant, spoken never signed: **no progress channel, no**

guide on demand, no comparing children. Then the question: *"What would that cost you? Say it now, while it's cheap."* - The Log is the learner's. No one reads it. Not the guide. Not you. - The learner's yes comes later, alone. Yours does not stand in for it.

What we ask: - What do you hope this does for your kid? (Listen for outcome-promises we must not make.) - What worries you about it? - What does your family need from a place like this that we haven't named? - Is there anything about your kid's learning, body, or life that we should know so the room can actually hold them? (Read against the access statement. Answer honestly.) - What would make you pull them out?

What we do not ask for: transcripts, grades, test scores, diagnoses, essays, references, a photo, or the learner's interior.

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5. The learner's yes (a week later, alone)

About a week after the conversations, the learner is asked, on their own, without a parent present, by the second adult where §8 applies: *"Is this yours? You can say no, and nothing changes between us."*

Any medium: a text, a note, a drawing, a voice memo, a conversation. A "not yet" or a "no" is honored as fully as a yes and is never carried to the parent as a problem to fix.

No yes from the learner, no seat. The parent's yes does not stand in.

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6. The guide's notes and the reply

Notes: one page, paper, against §2. For each sign: yes / no / not seen, and one sentence of what was seen. **No numbers.** The second adult reads and countersigns. The notes are kept with the family record and shown on request; never used for anything else.

The reply, within two weeks, in writing, to every family: - *Yes:* the seat, the start date, the Family note to countersign, and the sentence "you can still say no." - *We can't hold this:* the honest reason in plain words, tied to the access statement, and a real referral (a named person or program, not "look elsewhere"). Written by the guide, read by Accord (or the second adult) before it is sent. It must pass the Exhale Test: a family can read it and breathe. - *Not this year (see §7):* the reason, a place on the list, and a real next door.

Rule (Naomi's): "not this year" is never "not you." A reply without a written reason and a warm next step is the crossing we are watching for.

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7. If more than seven fit

The eight signs are yes/no. They are never ranked. If more learners fit than the room can hold:

1. First, the honest number. The year plan's target is five to six; seven is the ceiling because the deep block splits at six with an infant worn. The guide names the real number for this year before choosing anyone.
2. The method is **stated to families before application opens**, so no one learns it after. Three the fleet put on the table, unresolved, captain's call:
    - **Lottery among those who fit.** The least class-marked. Any "reasoned choice" drifts toward the articulate family.
    - **Readiness to start.** The learner who is sixteen by the cutoff and has no other door this year, before the one who could wait a cycle and lose nothing.
    - **Reasoned choice with a written reason per family**, countersigned by the second adult.
3. Every family that fits and is not seated: a written reason, a place on the list in the order the method produced, and a real next door (the next cycle, the Adventure studio, another program).
4. **The list is the renewal channel, not a courtesy.** The mid-cycle joiner the design already welcomes comes from here.

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8. The founder's child, and her community's children

Any child of the founder, or of her close community, gets exactly the same conversation, with one change: **the second adult leads**, the guide is present but not leading, and the learner's yes (§5) is asked by the second adult in private. That learner needs a real way to say no to someone who is not the person they love.

Enrollment of the founder's own child is decided by the accountability node (pilot default: Salus and Jake) with the guide, never by this conversation alone and never by the guide alone. The clause routes into the Family Charter draft that goes to counsel.

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9. Before first use (binding)

- [ ] Access statement written, Chekov Tier-1 read, published to families
- [ ] Family note (one page) written and published
- [ ] These fit signs published to families, plain language, Kira read
- [ ] Interpreter arranged and funded for the family conversation and the learner's yes (§1.1), with the no-child-interpreter rule stated to whoever books it
- [ ] Plain-language pass at eighth grade on every family-facing piece, Kira's read
- [ ] Second adult named for the conversations
- [ ] Comes walks this document as a sixteen-year-old applicant and reports what the body says
- [ ] Accord reviews the "we can't hold this" and "not this year" letter templates
- [ ] Oversubscription method chosen by the captain and stated in the family materials
- [ ] The pilot morning has run and been watched (the first no, met or managed)

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10. Deliberately NOT in this instrument

No score. No rank. No numbered sequence of "levels." No test, essay, transcript, grades, references, or diagnosis. No recording or transcript of the conversation. No homework before enrollment. No question that harvests the learner's interior (family story, worst day, grief) - those belong to the formation, later, with the floor under them, not to the door. No urgency and no scarcity in any family-facing sentence. No "fit" as a stand-alone verdict.

Origin asks "who am I?" of a learner who does not yet know. The door must not demand the answer first.

"We evoke - we never extract."

The Ballast and the Open Days - for the learner who joins a season later

Status: v0.1 working draft, authored 2026-09-25 from the 8-voice fleet meeting (third sitting: Jake Sisko, Naomi Wildman, Pavel Chekov, Kira Nerys, Ibn Khaldun, Comes, Accord, Cura). **Companions:** `2028-2029-launch-pad-studio-year-plan-forge-v0.1.md` (the joiner scaffold, already specified), `2026-06-24-launch-pad-three-year-story-cycle-v0.1.md` (the cycle, the portable foundation), `2027-2028-launch-pad-first-cohort-conversation-v0.1.md` (the door), `launch-pad-promotion-and-the-not-shown-wall-v0.1.md` (what may be shown). **Minutes:** `evoke-agents-backup/agents/meetings/2026/09/2026-09-25-launch-pad-the-waiting-learner.md`

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0. The first thing to say to the family

There is no Year One to miss.

The Launch Pad is a cycle, not a ladder. The seasons are Origin, The Forge, and The Helm, and they turn. A learner who starts at The Forge in August 2028 walks The Forge, then The Helm, then Origin, and launches having walked all three. The design refuses the words "Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3" precisely because they rank a learner who enters mid-cycle as behind, and that learner is not behind.

More than that: **The Forge is the kindest season to enter cold.** The year plan says so in its own words. It is outward at a shared problem rather than baring an interior, and mixed tenure is a resource there, not a gap. A learner who cannot be in the room this year and can be next year is not settling for a worse door. In some ways they are getting the better one.

So the honest answer to "can we give them packets?" is: **yes, a small one, and it is not a year of Origin at a distance.** The room is always better than the packet, and the design has already built everything they need for the day they arrive.

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1. What already exists (so we do not build it twice)

The Forge year plan specifies a **joiner scaffold** that must be built before any mid-cycle joiner arrives. Four parts:

1. **The Fast-Origin seed** - about two to three weeks, embedded in the joiner's own self-guided blocks in weeks 1 to 3, explicitly *not* a parallel Origin: a rapid 100 Dreams, an agency inventory, and a routine that holds. The three Origin functions The Forge silently stands on. Re-enterable, never a gate.
2. **The Captain's Log from day one** - "every Log starts empty; yours starts now, same first page." By lens, never by page count.
3. **A returner peer-witness pairing** - reciprocal, not tutoring. The joiner witnesses a returner's carried-forward dream; the returner witnesses the joiner naming theirs.
4. **A shared threshold season-opener** the whole room crosses together, and **no visible catch-up** - the seed lives in the joiner's own blocks, and in the shared deep hour they are a full Forge learner from the first morning.

Read that carefully: the joiner needs nothing before they arrive. The readiness is built in the room, by design, in their first three weeks. Nothing in The Ballast is a prerequisite, and nothing in it is remedial.

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2. What The Ballast is

Ballast is what a ship carries low in the hull to stay steady in open water. It is not cargo, and it is not homework.

A small paper packet, given once, to a named learner who has said yes and is waiting a season. Four things, and no more.

What	Why it travels safely	Notes
A Captain's Log	It is theirs, carried all three years anyway. Starting it during the wait is pure gain and carries no interior risk the design has not already accepted	The real notebook, named by them. Captured however they hold it: written, spoken, drawn, dictated, or told to someone beside them. No form is the lesser Log
The 100 Dreams card	Already designed as a Day-1 take-home. It is expansive, not excavating: it asks what you want, never what happened to you	The rule, the wall at forty, the warm spark bank. Bring the list when you come. **The dream session happens in the room**

What	Why it travels safely	Notes
The Vineyard card	Un-harvested joy. Nothing is reported, so nothing can go wrong	"There is a part of each week that is just yours to love. Nobody will ever ask what it was for." Named now, tended for as long as they like
A Weekly Plan pad	A routine that holds is the most transferable of Origin's three functions, and the least interior	The accessible version with starter banks, not blank lines

That is the whole packet. It maps onto the Fast-Origin seed's own three functions plus the two carried objects, and it does not duplicate the agency inventory, which is better done in the room in week two.

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3. What is deliberately NOT in it

This half matters more than the first half.

- **The Lineage (Origin Session 2)** and the mortality listening. It needs the preview, the real exit, the room, and the potluck.
- **The Full Draft (Origin Session 5).** The worst day, the loss, the whole life written out. This is the heaviest interior surface in the program. Alone, unheld, with no somatic floor, no guide watching the room, and no referral pathway in reach, it is precisely what the safety architecture forbids. **This one is not a preference. It is the floor.**
- **Chapter One (Origin Session 6).** The shrink mechanic needs a guide holding it, or "cut to focus, never to hide" collapses into cutting to hide.
- **The Unveiling (Origin Session 7).** It needs an audience and a feast.
- **The dream session.** You can write a hundred dreams alone. You cannot have the dream session alone, because the whole mechanism is that dreams are contagious in a room.
- **Any Socratic work.** That is a conversation, not a worksheet.
- **Anything to submit, complete, review, or be graded on.** There is no such thing anywhere in this program, and a packet is exactly where it would sneak back in.

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4. The five rules that keep it from becoming something else

1. **No guide obligation.** No check-ins, no submissions, no feedback, no deadline, no reply owed. If the guide must hold the waiting learner, a second cohort has been created without anyone deciding to create one, and the capacity ceiling that keeps this program honest has been breached quietly.
2. **Nothing comes back.** Nothing in The Ballast is read by anyone, ever. Not the guide, not a parent. Same rule as the Log, for the same reason.
3. **Arriving empty is arriving fine.** A learner who opens none of it and walks in next August is not behind, is never treated as behind, and hears that said out loud on their first day. The empty basket is a true harvest here too. If The Ballast ever produces a two-tier room, the ones who did it and the ones who did not, it has harmed the thing it was meant to serve.
4. **Never sold, never scaled.** The Ballast goes to named learners on the waitlist who have said yes. It is not a product, not a sample, not a lead magnet, and not a warm thing we send so a family does not go elsewhere. That last one is a re-engagement hook, and re-engagement hooks are on the "deliberately NOT built" wall.
5. **Cheap, portable, and printer-free.** A notebook, three cards, a pad. No supplies to buy, no quiet desk assumed, no parent required to help. The learner who cannot be in the room this year often cannot be there because of a job, a sibling to care for, a distance, or money. A packet that needs a study and a helpful adult is a packet for a different family.

Plus Chekov's floor, which is not optional: large print by default, left-aligned sans serif, high contrast, and every prompt answerable by voice or drawing.

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5. The Open Days - better than the packet

The waiting learner is not a correspondence student. They are a person the room already said yes to, who is not in it yet. Cohesion is built by walking somewhere together, never by mail.

So the guide invites them to the parts of Origin that carry no interior load:

- **An expedition.** Origin runs real-world and outdoor adventures all year. A whole day, outside, shoulder to shoulder, nothing to bare.
- **The Table**, a few times across the year. We eat together and the guide eats with you. Bring your own lunch, the same as everyone else does. Beyond that the ritual asks nothing of you: you do not have to eat, and nobody watches anybody's plate. *(Open: a waiting learner who cannot bring food is the same unbuilt floor as a enrolled one, and arguably sharper, since they are being invited as a guest.)*

- **The closing feast**, at the year's end.

And one that is **not the guide's to offer: the Unveiling.** Session 7 is the cohort standing up and saying "this is me" to a real audience. Whether a future cohort-mate sits in that audience is **the cohort's call, not the guide's**, made with the Cohort Call primitive. If they say no, that is a full and honored answer and the waiting learner is never told it was a no about them.

(Note the Guest Chair logic here: the proudest public act structurally includes someone from outside. This is that instinct, aimed one season forward.)

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6. How much room, honestly

This is the captain's dial, and it changes nothing structural.

If the learner can…	Then
Not be in the room at all this year	The Ballast plus the Open Days, as above
Come some mornings	Come. Self-guided mornings are the natural fit: they are already the shape of a day a learner runs themselves. The Ballast becomes unnecessary in most of its parts
Come most of the year but not enroll	Then this is a different conversation, and it is a Family Charter and counsel question, not a packet question

In every case, the rule holds: more room is better than more paper. Paper is what we send when the room is genuinely out of reach.

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7. The questions that are not ours to answer

- **Is a Ballast learner enrolled?** No. They are a named yes on the waitlist. That distinction is load-bearing for duty of care, consent, and insurance, and it goes to counsel with the Family Charter.
- **Does money change hands? No.** The Ballast is a gift. The moment a family pays for it, it is a product and a correspondence course, and every rule in section 4 collapses at once.
- **Who decides about the Unveiling?** The cohort, through the Cohort Call. Not the guide.

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8. What to say, in one paragraph

> *Your learner said yes, and the room is full this year. Here is what that actually means. The Launch Pad turns like seasons, so there is no Year One to miss. They will start at The Forge next August, walk The Helm, then walk Origin, and launch having done all three. The Forge is honestly the kindest season to walk into new. They do not need to prepare, and nothing is expected of them between now and then. I am giving them a notebook that will be theirs for three years, a card about dreaming, a card about the one thing they get to love for no reason, and a weekly planner if they want one. Nobody will read any of it. If they never open it, they arrive exactly on time. And I will invite them on an expedition or two and to a few shared meals this year, because the best preparation for a room is having been in it.*

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9. Before first use

- [ ] The joiner scaffold built (Fast-Origin seed, Log day one, peer-witness pairing, shared threshold) - owed by the Forge year plan before any joiner arrives, independent of this document
- [ ] Chekov Tier-1 read on the four printed pieces
- [ ] Accord reads the paragraph in section 8 and the “arriving empty” line for the exhale
- [ ] Comes walks it as the waiting sixteen-year-old
- [ ] The Cohort Call primitive drafted (one page) before any Unveiling invitation is considered
- [ ] Counsel: enrolled-or-not, with the Family Charter
- [ ] Naomi’s watch armed: the day The Ballast is sold, scaled, checked-in-on, or sent to someone who has not already said yes

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Ballast is not cargo. Nothing here is homework. The room is the thing; this is just what we hand you while you wait for it.

“We evoke - we never extract.”

The Family's Path - what a family and a learner receive, and in what order

Status: v0.1 working draft, authored 2026-09-26. A sequence and a gap map, not a new design. Everything here was decided in the three 8-voice sittings of 2026-09-24 and 2026-09-25; this document only puts the pieces in order and marks which ones do not exist yet. **Companions:** `2027-2028-launch-pad-first-cohort-conversation-v0.1.md` (the door), `launch-pad-promotion-and-the-not-shown-wall-v0.1.md` (what may be shown), `launch-pad-the-ballast-and-open-days-v0.1.md` (the waiting learner), `launch-pad-STATUS-AND-HANDOFF.md` §5 (the owed writing list).

Not convened as a fourth meeting. Sequencing decisions the room already made is execution, and a fourth sitting on the same program in three days would be the articulateness pattern both Cura and Naomi watch for. The standing conditions still govern every piece below: Chekov on access, Kira on plain language, Accord on the exhale, Comes on the walk.

Three rules that set the order

1. **The limits arrive before the invitation.** The access statement, the cost, the exit, and the removal policy are published before a family is ever asked to be interested. A family that reads them and steps away has been served well. Consent that hides its limits is not consent.
2. **Nothing arrives that assumes a yes not yet given.** No notebook before a seat. No Ballast before a place on the list. No Charter before a conversation.
3. **The learner gets their own copies.** Almost everything at the door is written to a parent. The learner chooses the mode of their own conversation, gives their own yes a week later, and is the person the three years happen to. They should have read things themselves, in their own hands, not filtered.

The path

Status key: **HAVE** exists and is usable · **HAVE (cut)** exists but needs a family-facing version pulled out of an internal doc · **MISSING** does not exist

Stage 0 - Published, before anyone raises a hand

A family should be able to rule themselves in or out without ever talking to Erin.

Piece	Status	Where it is / what it needs
The Launch Pad Story poster and one-pager	**HAVE**	`portfolio/20-*.pdf`
What it costs	**MISSING**	No Launch Pad document names a number. The year plan says "Erin sets the real local number." This is the second question every family asks. Jenna and Wes hold the price
The access statement (what one guide can hold, what they cannot, who we point you toward)	**MISSING**	Owed since Ring 3. Chekov's condition: no conversation happens before it exists
The one-page Family note (what this is and is not, how you leave, how removal works, the appeal path)	**MISSING**	Owed in the handoff §5, item 3
The fit signs, in plain language	**HAVE (cut)**	Door doc §2. Needs a one-page family-facing version

Stage 1 - The letter

Piece	Status	Notes
The invitation letter, Erin's voice	**HAVE**	Promotion doc §5. Carries or points at all of Stage 0
Kira plain-language and interpreter read	owed	Standing condition
Accord exhale read	owed	Standing condition

Stage 2 - On interest, before any conversation

Piece	Status	Notes
The three lesson plan books, printed	**HAVE**	`portfolio/10-*.pdf` , 76 pages, verified free of fleet names. The strongest thing we have: a parent reads what their kid will do and the kid reads the same pages

Piece	Status	Notes
What a Tuesday actually looks like, one page	**MISSING**	The hour-by-hour grid exists inside the internal year plan. It is the single most concrete thing a teenager wants and it cannot be handed over as-is
The year calendar	**MISSING**	Dates exist in the year plan (Aug 16 opens, seven sessions, Open Waters to late May). A family needs term dates, breaks, the harvest dates and the feast on one printed page
The FAQ	**MISSING**	College, a diploma, sports, what if my kid hates it, what if we move, can they do this and part-time school. Its hardest question is the transcript, and the design already says name a dual-enrollment owner and make the first CWI or BSU call
A learner-facing page	**MISSING**	Everything above is addressed to a parent. What this is, what we look for, what you can say no to, how the conversation works, in the learner's hands

Stage 3 - The evening in the room

Piece	Status	Notes
The evening, designed	**HAVE**	Promotion doc §3: the settle, a choice game, the Table, the refusals read aloud, no learners present
The run sheet	**MISSING**	Designed but not written as something to hold. Accord owes the exhale read on it
The mode menu, handed to the learner	**HAVE**	Door doc §3.1. The learner chooses, so the learner receives it
Low-sensory seat, written version of everything said	room property	Chekov's condition, built in rather than offered on request

Stage 4 - The two conversations

Piece	Status	Notes
The learner conversation, shape and questions	**HAVE**	Door doc §3, questions rewritten direct 2026-09-26
The family conversation	**HAVE**	Door doc §4, including the three parent refusals
The guide's card	**MISSING**	One page to hold in the room: the pass sentence, the shape, the questions, the eight fit signs marked yes, no or not seen. The second adult countersigns

Stage 5 - The week alone

Piece	Status	Notes
The learner's own yes	no document, deliberately	Asked a week later, alone, in any medium. Led by the second adult where §8 applies

Stage 6 - The reply, in writing, within two weeks, to every family

Piece	Status	Notes
The yes letter	**MISSING**	The seat, the start date, the Charter to countersign, and "you can still say no"
The "we can't hold this" letter	**MISSING**	The honest reason tied to the access statement plus a real named referral. Accord reads it before any send
The "not this year" letter	**MISSING**	The reason, a place on the list, a real next door. Never "not you"

Stage 7 - On a yes

Piece	Status	Notes
The Family Charter and Enrollment Covenant, countersigned	**MISSING**	Pilot runs on the one-page Family note; the full Charter is P1 and goes to counsel

Piece	Status	Notes
The Ballast, if they are waiting a season	**HAVE**	`launch-pad-the-ballast-and-open-days-v0.1.md`. Free, four items, no guide obligation

Stage 8 - Day one

Piece	Status	Notes
Captain's Log, 100 Dreams card, Year-Map, Weekly Plan pad, Five-Region map	**HAVE (spec)**	Session 1 materials list. Print and buy before Aug 16
The Two-Way Deal: the six refusals read as a promise, then the tribe co-writes its agreements	**HAVE**	Session 1 day-by-day, Day 1
The learner's own copy of the six refusals, to keep	**MISSING**	They exist as a Day-1 activity but not as an object the learner holds. "These are promises to you, and you can hold us to them"

What is missing, ranked

Seven of the gaps above are ordinary writing. Three of them block the door.

1. **The cost.** No Launch Pad document names a number, and the door has a hole in the middle without one. Jenna and Wes hold it.
2. **The access statement.** Named as owed in three consecutive sittings. Chekov's condition is binding: no conversation before it exists, because "not a fit" enforced without it is disability screening nobody decided to do.
3. **What happens if something happens to you.** A family committing a child to three years with a solo guide who is pregnant will ask this, and the honest answer today is a document that does not exist. The Successor Envelope is already P0-2, the first item on the handoff's founder list, to be authored while rested and co-signed. It is also the answer to the hardest question at the door.

Then, in rough order of how soon a family will want them: a day on a page; the year calendar; the learner-facing page; the FAQ with a named owner for the dual-enrollment clock; the three reply letters; the guide's card; the evening run sheet; the learner's refusals card.

What would support the adventure, beyond the paperwork

Three things the design already names and has not built, which would do more for a family's confidence than any additional document.

- **The named outside adult, on paper.** One external, non-founder, non-parent, non-employee adult, reachable directly by the learner and the family, who can say a binding no the guide cannot overrule. It is already the single consolidated Ring-3 hook. A family reading that sentence in the Family note relaxes in a way no reassurance achieves.
- **The dual-enrollment bridge, with an owner and a clock.** The credential question is the one a parent loses sleep over, and the design says the window closes on a clock nobody owns. One phone call converts the FAQ's weakest answer into its strongest.
- **The Cohort Call, one page.** The consent primitive the cohort uses to decide the things that are theirs, including who sits in their Unveiling. It seats in Origin Session 3, and it is what makes "co-created" true rather than decorative.

The limits first, the warmth second, and nothing that assumes a yes the family has not given.

"We evoke - we never extract."

The Access Statement - working draft, and what it still needs

Status: v0.2 WORKING DRAFT, 2026-09-26. **Not for families yet.** Part 1 is the family-facing text, assembled from commitments the design has already made, plus Erin's six decisions of 2026-09-26. Part 2 is what remains: three open questions, a site walk, one list that does not exist, and the counsel question this rides with. **Blocking before publish:** the site walk (Q5), the exceeds-capacity referral list (D), and the three open questions. **Why it exists:** Ring 3, Chekov. A real capacity limit exists and no line states it honestly, so it gets enforced invisibly as "not a fit," which is disability screening nobody decided to do. *"The learner who quietly could not participate never says no. They just don't come back. That silence is the barrier that hides best."* **Binding:** no first conversation runs before this is published. Chekov's condition, held in all three sittings. **Companions:** `2027-2028-launch-pad-first-cohort-conversation-v0.1.md` (the door), `launch-pad-the-familys-path-v0.1.md` (where this sits in the sequence), `2027-2028-launch-pad-coach-not-therapist-referral-pathway-v0.1.md` (the crisis roster, which is a different list).

The rule that governs every line

Describe the room, never the learner.

"There is no aide" is a fact about the room, and a family can decide what it means for them. "We cannot take a learner who needs an aide" is a fact about a learner, and it is the screening Chekov named. Every sentence below describes what is and is not in the room. None of them describes a kind of person.

The second rule follows from it: **this is read before the conversation, never during it.** A limit discovered in the room is a limit that has already done its damage.

Part 1 - The family-facing text (draft)

What this room can hold

The Launch Pad at Vibrant Life, 2027-2028

Before you decide whether this is right for your learner, here is an honest description of the room. We would rather you know now than find out in March.

Who is here

One guide, Erin. She holds a current CPR certification, a life coaching certification, and a degree in psychology. She is not a licensed clinician, and this is not therapy.

She will have a baby with her on guide days, worn while she works. There is no aide, no assistant, and no second teacher.

Tuesday and Thursday mornings she is in the room with the learners from 9:00 to 1:00. Monday and Wednesday mornings the learners run the morning themselves while she is on site in another room with the younger children, and she checks in around midday. Friday is not a studio day.

The room holds five to seven learners.

The space

`[PENDING SITE WALK — see Part 2, Q5. Do not publish this section until the room, the route in and the bathroom have been measured rather than remembered.]`

What the room provides

- **Anything written can also be said, drawn, typed, recorded, or told to someone who writes it down.** No version counts less than another. This holds for the Captain's Log, the hundred dreams, and every reflection all year.
- **Every circle has a way in that is not speaking:** a written card, an object, a drawing, or a pass with a nod. Passing is always allowed and never needs a reason.
- **Every "place yourself" activity has a seated version,** and every expedition has an equal alternative that is not a lesser version of it.
- **Handouts come in large print,** high contrast, left aligned, with starter banks instead of blank pages, and an icon version for anyone who freezes at a form.

- **Tools you can pick up and put down:** a timer, a template, someone to work alongside, a visible board showing where you are. Nobody is assigned these and nobody is tracked using them.
- **A quiet place to go, and standing permission to go there without asking.**
- **A shared meal on every guide day. Learners bring their own lunch; the studio does not provide the food.** We stop and eat together, the guide sits and eats with the learners, and nobody has to eat. Presence is the requirement, never consumption, and nobody watches anybody's plate. On the two days a year when there is shared food, the autumn potluck and the May feast, allergen, cultural and religious needs are planned in advance.
    - `INTERNAL, NOT FOR FAMILIES — split out with the others. The equity half of the Table floor is unbuilt as of 2026-10-19. It used to rest on a provided base meal and a no-cover-charge rule. Bring-your-own exposes a learner who cannot bring lunch, twice a week, at the belonging ritual. This statement must not publish until that is answered: a standing backstop on the table, or the honest blank. A door that only appears when someone needs it announces them for needing it.`
- **If being around people is genuinely hard,** the weekly accountability rhythm can run with the guide or on your own time instead of with a partner, and nobody reads that as failing to bond.
- **Pace is set by readiness, not by a date.** Scaffolding that stays in place all year is a real path, not a delay.
- **Nothing is graded, ranked, or compared,** and there are no deadlines a learner did not set.

What the room does not provide

- **No aide** or one-to-one support person.
- **No speech, occupational, physical, or behavioural therapy,** and nobody on site qualified to provide them.
- **No special education instruction, and no IEP or 504 plan.** We are not a school district and cannot write or carry out either one.
- **No evaluation or diagnosis** of anything.
- **No counselling or therapy.** Erin is a coach and a mentor, not a clinician. She does not diagnose and does not treat. If something comes up that is past coaching, her job is to stay with your learner and route to real help quickly, and she will tell you when that happens.
- **No nursing care.** Erin holds a current CPR certification. Beyond that there is no medical training here and no nurse on site. `[ERIN + COUNSEL — see Part 2, Q4: medication, and what medical plans one adult with an infant can honestly run]`

- **No physical intervention.** Nobody is restrained in this room. If someone is in danger, the plan is to get people to safety and call for help. That is a choice about how this room works, not a gap in it.
- **No adult in the room with the learners on Monday and Wednesday mornings.** Erin is on site and reachable, in another room, for about three hours. If your learner cannot hold three hours on their own, tell us and we will think it through together. Things we can talk about: a parent or another adult on site for those mornings, or a later start. Some situations we will not be able to solve, and we will say so plainly rather than let you find out in November.
- **Not an undivided adult on guide days.** There is a baby. The deep hour is protected and has a plan for when she needs tending, and some days it will still be interrupted.
- **One block of each guide day needs a room that can largely hold itself.** That block is the deep conversation. Occasional redirection is ordinary and fine. Continuous one-to-one attention is more than one adult can hold while also holding the hour.

What to tell us

We are not asking for a diagnosis, and we do not need one. We are asking what shapes whether this particular room works for your learner. Useful things to tell us:

- What helps them learn, and what gets in the way
- How they like to get their thoughts down
- What would make this room hard: noise, light, food, sitting still, being read aloud to, being looked at
- Anything about three self-managed hours on Monday and Wednesday we should think through together
- Anything medical that would need a plan
- Anything about a daily shared meal we should know

If this is not the right room

Sometimes the honest answer is that we cannot hold what your learner needs. If that happens we will tell you plainly, in writing, and we will tell you why. Then we will point you somewhere real. We will not say “not a fit” and leave you to guess.

`[ERIN – see Part 2, item D: the named list of where we point people]`

Part 2 - What this still needs

A. The nine judgment calls

Six settled with Erin on 2026-09-26. Three remain, and none of the three can be settled by her alone.

Settled

#	The call	What Part 1 now says
Q1	**Three unsupervised hours.** Not a flat structural limit. Tell us and we plan it together	The three hours are stated as fact, followed by an invitation to raise it and two concrete things that can be talked about (an adult on site those mornings, a later start), plus the honest line that some situations will not be solvable and we will say so rather than let a family find out in November. **The named examples exist because a private case-by-case judgment with no written criteria is where invisible screening lives**
Q3	**Redirection.** Occasional yes, continuous no	Written as a fact about the hour, not about a learner: one block of each guide day needs a room that can largely hold itself
Q5	**The building.** Needs measuring, not remembering	Section held with a `[PENDING SITE WALK]` marker. Checklist below. Do not publish with it unfilled

#	The call	What Part 1 now says
Q7	**Behaviour.** Describe the room; the credentials move up front	Erin's CPR certification, life coaching certification and psychology degree are named in *Who is here*, with "not a licensed clinician" in the same breath, because credentials sitting beside a crisis paragraph read as clinical capacity and that is the misread the referral pathway exists to prevent. The behaviour line itself is now: nobody is restrained here, and if someone is in danger the plan is to get people to safety and call. **A choice about how the room works, not a gap in it**
Q8	**If Erin is out for a day.** Out of this document	Moves to the Family note. Keeps the access statement about access specifically
Q9	**Whose statement.** Launch Pad now, flagged as precedent	Published for the studio. **Jenna and Wes are told plainly, before it goes out, that it will read as the school's template**, because there is no school-wide access statement anywhere in Vibrant Life today

Still open

#	The question	Who has to be in it
Q2	**The Table.** A shared meal every guide day, with a learner in active eating-disorder recovery. Can the room hold that?	**The clinician, not only Erin.** The inclusion floor already says presence not consumption and no plate is watched, which is good design but is not a clinical judgment. Salus's HOLD-FOR-HUMAN on Wellness is the adjacent precedent

#	The question	Who has to be in it
Q4	**Medical.** Medication administration, a seizure disorder, Type 1 diabetes, an allergy needing epinephrine. What can one adult with an infant and a CPR certification honestly run?	**Counsel, plus Erin.** Rides with the C bundle below
Q6	**Emerging English.** Origin is a writing-heavy season. Multi-modal capture is already law, which helps. Is that enough?	**Erin, with Kira's read.** Boise has refugee resettlement families, and this is where the plurality finding lands

The site walk (Q5) - measure, do not remember

- Doorway widths: the room, and the bathroom
- A step-free route from drop-off to the room, including any threshold strips
- Bathroom: same floor, turning space, grab bars, door that can be managed one-handed
- Inside the room: can a wheelchair reach the circle, the Table, and the agreements wall
- Light: can it be dimmed, and is it fluorescent
- Sound: what is adjacent on Tue and Thu mornings, and can it be quieted
- The quiet space: where it is, whether it can be reached without asking, and whether it is accessible
- The exit route in an emergency, by the same test

B. The dependency nobody has named

The crisis roster and the exceeds-capacity list are two different lists, and only one exists.

The referral pathway has a real roster already built: 988, Crisis Text Line, Clarvida Youth Support Center in Boise, Idaho DHW mandatory reporting, 2-1-1, SAMHSA. Real numbers, current, good work. It has exactly one blank, the named warm-referral therapist, which is P0-1.

But that roster is for **crisis routing**, and the access statement needs a different one: **where a family goes when the honest answer is that this room cannot hold what their learner needs.** That is not a crisis. It is "this is not the right room, and here is a room that might be." Nothing in any document names those places.

Without it, the last section of the statement is a promise we cannot keep, and the whole document reverts to "not a fit," which is the thing it exists to prevent.

C. The counsel question it rides with

Do not send this to counsel alone. It belongs in the same conversation as the duty-of-care question the year plan already flagged: on Monday and Wednesday mornings, learners aged sixteen to eighteen are self-managing while Erin is on site but in the Tots room. Is “on site and reachable” sufficient under Idaho and umbrella-school rules, or must an adult be in the room?

Q1 and Q4 above are the same conversation. One engagement, three answers. This is G1, the long pole, and the one gate the fleet cannot self-certify.

D. The one list to build

Boise-area places to point a family when the answer is no. Real names and current numbers, the same standard the crisis roster already meets. Candidates worth calling: the district’s special education office, homeschool co-ops with aide support, private programs with special education staffing, a special education advocate, the state parent training and information centre, the library’s accessibility services.

Small research task. Nothing blocks starting it today.

E. The reads

- **Chekov, Tier 1.** He named the finding and holds the read on the finished statement.
- **Kira.** Plain language at eighth grade, interpreter offered.
- **Accord.** The Exhale Test on the “what the room does not provide” section and on the “not the right room” letter, which is the same family reading both.
- **Comes.** Reads it as the sixteen-year-old, not only as the parent. The learner reads this too.

F. Sequence

1. ~~Erin answers the nine~~ **six done 2026-09-26.** Q2, Q4 and Q6 remain
2. Walk the building with the checklist above and fill *The space*
3. Build the list in D, and make the calls for the P0-1 clinician in the same week, since they are the same kind of phone call. **Q2 is answered in that same clinician conversation**
4. Send the statement to counsel bundled with the Monday and Wednesday duty-of-care question, which also answers Q4
5. Chekov, Kira, Accord and Comes read. **Q6 is answered inside Kira’s read**

6. Jenna and Wes see it before it publishes, and are told plainly it will read as the school's template
7. Publish, at Stage 0, before any letter goes out and before any conversation happens

Note the shape: each of the three open questions is answered inside a step that was already owed. None of them needs its own meeting.

Decisions of 2026-09-26 (for the record)

Erin settled six of the nine in conversation. The two worth carrying forward as reasoning, not just as answers:

On Monday and Wednesday, she chose the open door over the clean limit. The warmer choice and probably the right one, but it costs a private judgment every time a family raises it, and a private judgment with no written criteria is the invisible screening this document exists to prevent. Hence the named example plans in Part 1. The examples are the criteria, made public.

On behaviour, she pushed back on the draft and was right. The original line read "nobody trained in physical intervention or crisis de-escalation," which describes a lack rather than a room, and understated a guide who holds CPR, a coaching certification and a psychology degree. Two fixes came out of it. The credentials moved to *Who is here*, because a psychology degree sitting beside a crisis paragraph reads as clinical capacity and the whole referral pathway exists to prevent that misread. And the behaviour line became a description of what the room does instead: nobody is restrained, people get to safety, someone calls.

The test she and the room used for any future training: **training that makes the routing faster and surer is aligned; training that makes the guide hold more clinical weight herself is drift**, because the entire safety floor rests on the coach-not-therapist boundary staying bright. By that test, Youth Mental Health First Aid and QPR sharpen the job the design already gives her. The physical-restraint half of crisis-intervention training moves the other way, against a program built on consent and the right to decline. *(Availability and current content of any named course need checking before anyone books one.)*

A limit written down is care. A limit enforced without being written down is screening. This document is the difference between the two.

"We evoke - we never extract."

Promoting the Launch Pad - the invitation, and the “Deliberately NOT Shown” wall

Status: v0.1 working draft, authored 2026-09-25 from the 8-voice fleet meeting (second sitting: Jake Sisko, Naomi Wildman, Pavel Chekov, Kira Nerys, Ibn Khaldun, Comes, Accord, Cura). Carries the outreach finding from the Ring-3 interdependence review (2026-09-01) as substrate. **Companions:** `2027-2028-launch-pad-first-cohort-conversation-v0.1.md` (the door), `2026-06-24-launch-pad-three-year-story-cycle-v0.1.md` (Ring-2 #8, the “deliberately NOT built” wall this is the sibling of), `launch-pad-STATUS-AND-HANDOFF.md` §5 (the one-page Family note and the access statement). **Minutes:** `evoke-agents-backup/agents/meetings/2026/09/2026-09-25-launch-pad-promotion-and-portfolio.md`

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0. The posture, in one line

Invitation, not persuasion. We recruit on the design and the refusals. We show the room, never the child. We state the limit as a limit, never as a lure. We promise the conditions, never the outcome.

The Launch Pad is a Vibrant Life studio. It is promoted by Vibrant Life and by Erin Stanley as its guide. No Evoked branding, no fleet names, no company story rides on it.

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1. The “Deliberately NOT Shown” wall

The outreach sibling of “deliberately NOT built” (three-year spec, Ring-2 #8). Written now because the pilot morning is the most photogenic, most shareable moment the program will ever produce, and it happens before any wall exists. Restraint that lives only in a reviewer’s head is a good intention waiting for a proud afternoon to overwrite it.

Never in any outreach, post, page, poster, letter, talk, or conversation:

1. **Interior work as content.** Not a dream from a 100-Dreams list, not a line from a Log, not a family story, not a Council deliberation, not a closing-practice answer. The interior is not the program’s to show.
2. **Transformation as proof.** No before/after. No “she came in shy and left a leader.” No arc told about a real learner.

3. **A learner's story, image, voice, or likeness**, except under a standard that is adult-only in decision, learner-owned, withdrawable at any time, owes no favor, and contains no interior content. Default: none. A minor cannot consent to indefinite public representation of their interior, and **a parent's consent is not the child's.**
4. **Outcome promises or alumni metrics.** No "graduates go on to." No numbers about learners, ever.
5. **A founder story whose emotional engine is a specific child's formation.** Erin may say why she built this. She may not make her son, or any child, the reason on a page.
6. **Re-contacting a graduate for a testimonial.** The exit is empty. That includes the exit into marketing.
7. **Urgency and scarcity.** "Only seven seats" is a fact when a family asks and a lever when it leads. It never leads. No deadlines dressed as excitement, no "spots are filling," no countdown.
8. **The pilot morning.** No photos, no write-up, no post. It is a mirror for the guide, not a launch event.
9. **Borrowed visual language of struggle or transformation** (protest typography, journey-to-triumph imagery). The poster is a star map and a cycle. It stays that.
10. **AI-generated imagery of children or of the room.** Photographs of the empty studio, hand drawings, and the existing brass-line design are the visual vocabulary.

What may be shown, freely: the design (the three lenses, the seven sessions, the weekly rhythm); the refusals, as the feature they are; the room, empty; the guide, as themselves; the honest limits; the price and the exit; the printed books, because a teenager can read every page of them.

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2. Who we invite, in order

1. **Current Vibrant Life families whose learner turns 16 by the 2027 cutoff.** The Compass already plants this intention: the Adventure-to-Launch-Pad pitch page ("will you have turned 16 by the cutoff? want to start getting ready?") is built and gated on the ratified thresholds. Turning it on is a code decision for the studio, not a promotion decision, and it is the one in-app door.
2. **Vibrant Life siblings and alumni families.** They already know what the school refuses.
3. **Jenna and Wes's community**, at their cadence and with their word, not ours.
4. **Boise's plural town**, through relationships rather than reach: the homeschool and co-op networks, the library (Boothby's sovereign research layer), the CWI/BSU dual-enrollment office (the credential bridge a family will ask about first). Each is a conversation, not a campaign.

5. **Never:** paid ads, cold lists, the Evoked audience, social posts that could be read as recruitment of strangers' children.

Target 5-6, ceiling 7 (year plan v0.3). If the first two circles fill the room, the third and fourth are relationships kept for the mixed-cycle joiner, not a second round of recruiting.

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3. What we show

- **The room.** One evening, "come see the room": families sit in the studio, do the thirty-second settle themselves, play one choice game, eat something at the Table, and hear the refusals read aloud. No learners on display. A low-sensory seat and a written version of everything said are available in the room, not on request.
- **The printed books.** The three lesson plan books (Origin, Forge, Helm) are the promotion. A parent reads what their kid will do; a teenager reads the same pages. Nothing is hidden, so nothing needs to be sold.
- **The poster and the one-pager.** The turning cycle, the three questions, the Captain's Log. Already made.
- **The honest limits, out loud and in print:** one guide, an infant worn on guide days, no aide; self-managed Monday and Wednesday mornings; a Growth Record no institution yet recognizes and the dual-enrollment bridge we will help build; the price; how you leave.
- **The door:** the first conversation, the access statement, the fit signs, published before anyone applies.

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4. The sentences

Use freely - "A three-year studio for learners aged 16 to 18. Not a high school." - "Two mornings a week with a guide. Two mornings the learner runs. Friday is never filled." - "No grades. No ranking. No deadlines you didn't set. Your Log is yours and no one reads it." - "Here is what one guide can hold, and here is what they can't." - "You can leave any time. Here is exactly how." - "The room has seven chairs this year." (When asked. Never as the opener.) - "Come sit in the room and decide for yourself."

Never - "Transform," "unlock," "unleash," "the leader your child was meant to be." - "Limited spots," "applications closing," "don't miss." - "Our graduates," "results," any number about a learner. - "Erin built this for her son." (Her reasons are hers to say in person; not on a page.) - Any sentence that makes a family feel they are behind if they say no.

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5. The invitation letter (draft, Erin's voice, to a family that already knows Vibrant Life)

> *Hello,*
>
> *Next August, Vibrant Life opens a studio for learners who will be 16 by then: the Launch Pad. It is three years long. The first year asks one question, Who am I? The second asks What is worth solving? The third asks What do I do when there is no easy answer? I'll be the guide.*
>
> *It is not a high school. There are no grades, no rankings, and no deadlines the learner didn't set. Two mornings a week we work together; two mornings the learners run themselves; Friday stays empty on purpose. Each learner keeps a Log that nobody reads but them.*
>
> *I want to be plain about the limits. It is one guide, and I will have a baby with me on guide days. There is no aide. The record a learner leaves with is not a transcript any college yet recognizes; we will work on the dual-enrollment bridge together, and I'll tell you honestly where that stands. The room holds about six learners.*
>
> *I've printed the whole plan for all three years, written so your kid can read every page. If you'd like a copy, say so. If you'd like to come sit in the room one evening and try a morning yourselves, I'll set a date. If you'd rather not, nothing changes between us.*
>
> *Erin*

(Price, dates, and the exit procedure ride on the Family note that goes with this letter; the letter never carries them alone.)

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6. Timeline against the real clocks

When	What	Note
Now through Nov 2026	Access statement, one-page Family note, this wall, fit signs published	Prerequisites for any conversation (first-conversation doc §9)
Within ~3 weeks of the go	The pilot morning (2-4 teens, Salus + Jake)	Not a promotion event; not shown

When	What	Note
Jan 2027	Letters to Vibrant Life families with a learner turning 16; printed books available	Invitation, no deadline
Feb 2027	“Come see the room” evening	One evening; repeat once if asked
Feb through Mar 2027	First conversations (learner + family)	**Before April.** The guide’s baby is due in the spring; conversations should not land in the birth window. Second adult leads where §8 of the door applies
Apr 2027	Learners’ own yes (a week later, alone); replies to every family in writing	“Not this year” is never “not you”
May 2027	Family note countersigned; waitlist named	The list is the renewal channel
Aug 16, 2027	Origin opens	Target 5-6, ceiling 7

7. Who holds what

- **Erin (guide):** the letter, the evening, the conversations, the honest-limits sentences.
- **Jenna and Wes (Vibrant Life):** the school’s word to its community; the price; the in-app pitch page decision.
- **The second adult (pilot default Salus + Jake):** present at conversations; leads where the guide’s relationship makes a no expensive.
- **Chekov (Tier 1 read):** the access statement and the accessibility of every printed and spoken thing (large print available, plain language, a written version of the evening).
- **Kira (Tier 1 read):** plain language at eighth grade; interpreter offered; no borrowed visual language.
- **Accord:** the letter templates and the “come see the room” run sheet pass the Exhale Test.
- **Naomi (drift watch):** the wall, item by item, at every artifact before it goes out. The day a learner’s face, a number, or a countdown appears is the crossing.

8. Deliberately NOT in this plan

No campaign. No funnel. No newsletter list built from families. No tracking of who opened what. No social media recruitment of minors. No paid reach. No outcome language. No child on a page.

Show the room. Print the books. Say the limits. Then let the family decide.

“We evoke - we never extract.”